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INDO-MIM LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)



(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus)

Our Company was originally incorporated as 'A F Technologies India Private Limited' on April 12, 1996 at Hyderabad, Andhra Pradesh as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 1956, and was granted a certificate of incorporation by the Registrar of Companies, Andhra Pradesh at Hyderabad ("RoC Hyderabad"). The name of our Company was changed to 'Indo-US MIM Tech Private Limited' to ensure compliance with the conditions of termination of a collaboration agreement entered into by our Company, and a fresh certificate of incorporation pursuant to change of name was granted by the ROC Hyderabad on August 21, 2001. The name of our Company was changed to 'Indo-US MIM Tec Private Limited' to align the name of our Company with the name of the USA branch office of our Company as registered with USA authorities, and a fresh certificate of incorporation pursuant to change of name was granted by the ROC Hyderabad on September 28, 2001. Subsequently, the name of our Company was changed to 'Indo-MIM Private Limited' to align the name of our Company with our registered trademark, and a fresh certificate of incorporation pursuant to change of name was granted by the ROC Hyderabad on February 3, 2016. Our Company changed its registered office from Hyderabad, Telangana to Bangalore, Karnataka pursuant to the resolutions passed by our Board, and our Shareholders on February 14, 2020 and April 30, 2020 respectively. Consequently, a certificate of registration of regional director order for change of state was issued by the Registrar of Companies, Karnataka at Bengaluru ("RoC") on August 21, 2020. Subsequently, our Company was converted from a private limited company to a public limited company, pursuant to a special resolution passed by our Shareholders at the EGM held on September 5, 2023 and the name of our Company was changed to 'INDO-MIM Limited'. Consequently, a fresh certificate of incorporation pursuant to change of name was issued by the RoC on January 12, 2024. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters - Brief history of our Company" on page 226 of the red herring prospectus dated July 17, 2026, ("RHP" or "Red Herring Prospectus") filed with the RoC read with addendum dated July 13, 2026, to the draft red herring prospectus dated September 26, 2025 ("Addendum").

Registered and Corporate Office: 45(P), KIADB Industrial Area, Hoskote, Bangalore - 562 114, Karnataka, India; Tel: +91 81 2347 9565
Website: www.indo-mim.com; Contact Person: Santosh Kumar Dash, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; E-mail: santosh.d@indo-mim.com; Corporate Identity Number: U28110KA1996PLC137499

OUR PROMOTERS: GREEN MEADOWS INVESTMENTS LTD, KRISHNA CHIVUKULA, KRISHNA CHIVUKULA JR., RAJ CHIVUKULA AND JAGADAMBA CHANDRASEKHAR

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF INDO-MIM LIMITED ("COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SHARE PREMIUM OF ₹[•] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE"), AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION (THE "OFFER") COMPRISING OF A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [•] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹5,000.00 MILLION (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO 68,291,022 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION (THE "OFFER FOR SALE") COMPRISING OF UP TO 60,524,322 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION BY GREEN MEADOWS INVESTMENTS LTD (THE "CORPORATE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER"), UP TO 5,459,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION BY ANURADHA KODURI (THE "INDIVIDUAL PROMOTER GROUP SELLING SHAREHOLDER"), AND UP TO 2,307,700 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION BY INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY MADRAS (THE "OTHER SELLING SHAREHOLDER" AND COLLECTIVELY WITH THE CORPORATE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER AND INDIVIDUAL PROMOTER GROUP SELLING SHAREHOLDER, THE "SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND SUCH EQUITY SHARES OFFERED BY THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFERED SHARES"). THIS OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO 200,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [•]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER WOULD CONSTITUTE AT LEAST [•]% AND [•]%, RESPECTIVELY, OF OUR POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL. OUR COMPANY IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMS, MAY OFFER A DISCOUNT OF UP TO [•]%(EQUIVALENT TO ₹45 PER EQUITY SHARE) TO THE OFFER PRICE TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT"), SUBJECT TO NECESSARY APPROVALS AS MAY BE REQUIRED.

DETAILS OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, OFFER FOR SALE AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION

NAME OF SELLING SHAREHOLDER	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH OFFERED	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE (IN ₹)*
Green Meadows Investments Ltd	Corporate Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to 60,524,322 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[•] million	2.67
Anuradha Koduri	Individual Promoter Group Selling Shareholder	Up to 5,459,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[•] million	1.25
Indian Institute of Technology Madras	Other Selling Shareholder	Up to 2,307,700 Equity Shares of face value of ₹1 each aggregating up to ₹[•] million	Nil

*As certified by Suri & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN No. 004283S), by way of their certificate dated July 17, 2026. For further details, see "The Offer" on page 62 of the RHP dated July 17, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹ 461 TO ₹485 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE AND THE CAP PRICE ARE 461 TIMES AND 485 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES, RESPECTIVELY.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 30 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 1 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 30 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹1 EACH THEREAFTER.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹45 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.

THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 44.62 AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 42.41 AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 148.00*

WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS 19.61%.

*The industry high, low and average are the same because our Company has only one global listed peer i.e., Jiangsu Gian Technology Co, Ltd.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹461		At Cap Price of ₹485	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 1 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	10,845,986	5,000	10,309,278	5,000
Offer for Sale	68,291,022	31,482	68,291,022	33,121
Total Offer Size	79,137,008	36,482	78,600,300	38,121
Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company	494,999,058	228,195	494,462,350	239,814

BID/OFFER PERIOD

BID/OFFER OPEN

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON : MONDAY, JULY 27, 2026*

*The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/ Offer Closing Date.

We provide end-to-end solutions for the manufacture of precision engineering components using metal injection molding ("MIM") technology. In addition to MIM technology, we leverage technologies such as investment casting, precision machining, ceramic injection molding and metal three-dimensional ("3D") printing. Our product portfolio caters to automotive, defence, medical, consumer, and aerospace sectors.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE SHALL BE THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER
EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO 200,000 EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹[•] MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THIS PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER. ("BRLMs").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED JULY 18, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/ KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS ("KPI") DISCLOSED IN THE 'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE' SECTION ON PAGE 132 OF THE RHP VIS-A-VIS THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN 'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE' SECTION ON PAGE 132 OF THE RHP AND PROVIDED BELOW IN THE ADVERTISEMENT.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to section titled "Risk Factors" on page 18 of the RHP

1. Customer Concentration Risk:

Our Company's top 10 customers contributed 38.41%, 38.94% and 42.00% of our revenue from operations in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. The loss of such customers or a significant reduction in demand of our products from these customers could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. The following table sets forth our revenue from top 10 customers for the periods indicated:

Particulars	Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2024
Revenue from domestic customers (forming part of top 10 customers) (₹ million) (A)	5,916.83	1,005.55	1,353.87
Number of domestic customers (forming part of top 10 customers)	3	1	1
Revenue from overseas customers (forming part of top 10 customers) (₹ million) (B)	10,186.35	11,960.89	10,702.60
Number of overseas customers (forming part of top 10 customers)	7	9	9
Revenue from top 10 customers* (₹ million) (A + B)	16,103.18	12,966.44	12,056.47
Revenue from top 10 customers as a percentage of our revenue from operations (%)	38.41%	38.94%	42.00%

*References to 'customers' are to customers in a particular Fiscal and do not refer to the same customers across all Fiscals.

2. Geographical Concentration Risk:

We serve a customer base, spread across North America, Europe, South East Asia and other foreign countries. We export our products to various countries and our revenue from outside India represented 77.20%, 89.92% and 88.26% of the total revenue from operations in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any adverse changes in the conditions affecting the industries in global markets in which our products are supplied, can adversely impact our business, cash flows, results of operations and financial condition.

3. Export Dependence Risk

Our business is dependent on exports and the performance of geographies where we supply our products. Further, the imposition of tariffs by the US government under its "Fair and Reciprocal Plan", including the recent increase in import duties on Indian automotive components in August 2025, may impact Indian businesses, especially those with a substantial export presence in the US market. We may be subject to additional or increased tariffs or other trade-restrictive measures which could raise our cost of sales and erode the price competitiveness of our products in the USA, which may have an adverse impact on our business, results of operations, financial conditions and cash flows.

4. Supplier's Risk

Loss of any of our suppliers or a failure by our suppliers to deliver our primary raw materials such as metal powders and polymers may have an adverse impact on our ability to continue our manufacturing process without interruption. We procure our primary raw materials, including (i) metal powders such as carbonyl iron powder, stainless steel powder; and (ii) polymers such as poly propylene, wax, steric acid, on a purchase order basis. Our operations depend upon the uninterrupted availability of key raw materials procured from domestic and international suppliers. Any adverse development or disruption affecting either the supply or the market price of these raw materials could adversely affect our production schedules, cost structure and, consequently, our financial condition, results of operations and cash flows. For Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, we purchased raw materials from 753, 637 and 151 suppliers, of which 146, 127 and 74 were international suppliers, respectively. The table below sets forth details regarding supplies sourced from our top 10 suppliers in the years indicated:

Particulars	Fiscal		
	2026	2025	2024
Cost of raw materials purchased from top 10 suppliers (₹ million)	3,752.36	2,068.27	2,197.55
Cost of raw materials purchased from top 10 suppliers as a percentage of our total cost for purchase of raw materials (%)	42.91%	29.55%	44.68%

*References to 'Suppliers' are to suppliers in a particular Fiscal and do not refer to the same suppliers across all Fiscals. Further, names of the suppliers have not been included in the Red Herring Prospectus because relevant consents for disclosure of their names have not been received.

5. Operational Risk

We manufacture our products in India, the United States, United Kingdom and Mexico and distribute them globally. Our global operations are subject to risks that are specific to each country and region in which we operate, as well as risks associated with carrying out business operations on an international scale, including the social, economic, political, geopolitical conditions and adverse weather conditions.

6. Business Risk

A significant portion of our raw materials constituting 60.95%, 61.80% and 59.63% of our total purchases of raw materials in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Our operations and our suppliers' ability to provide raw materials to us at competitive prices is affected by global commodity prices, inflation and our ability to negotiate with our suppliers effectively. Any restrictions on imports or fluctuation in global commodity prices that affect our raw materials could adversely affect our business, results of operations, cash flows and financial condition.

7. Geographical concentration of Indian manufacturing facilities

Our manufacturing facilities in India are concentrated in south India and any adverse developments affecting this region could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. In India, we own and operate six manufacturing facilities in the states of Karnataka, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh. Any adverse social, political or economic development, natural calamities, civil disruptions, or changes in the policies of the central or state government or local governments in the southern region of India could adversely affect our manufacturing operations and transport operations.

8. Risks Relating to Our Manufacturing disruptions

As of the date of the Red Herring Prospectus, we operate 15 manufacturing facilities, of which, six are located in India, six in the United States, two in the United Kingdom and one in Mexico. Any unscheduled, unplanned or prolonged disruption of our manufacturing operations, including, power failure, fire, unexpected mechanical failure/breakdown of equipment, performance below expected levels of output or efficiency, obsolescence, labour disputes, strikes, lock-outs, earthquakes and other natural disasters, industrial accidents, any significant social, political or economic disturbances or infectious disease outbreaks, could reduce our ability to meet the conditions under our arrangements with customers and adversely affect our sales and revenue from operations in such period. The occurrence of any of these events could affect our operations by causing production at one or more manufacturing facilities to shut down or slowdown. While we have not experienced any breakdown or shutdown of our facilities in the last three Fiscals, which had an adverse impact on our business, results of operations, financial conditions and cash flows, we cannot assure you that such instances will not arise in the future.

9. Corporate Governance Risk

The name of one of our Promoters and our Chairman and Managing Director, Krishna Chivukula has appeared in the list of disqualified directors in the past. While Krishna Chivukula is not presently disqualified to be a director, there is no assurance that statutory or regulatory actions or legal proceeding will not be initiated against him. In future, in case of any actual or alleged non-compliance with regulatory requirements, our Promoter could be subject to investigations and administrative or judicial proceedings that may result in substantial penalties and/ or diversion of management's attention, which could negatively affect our reputation and may have a material adverse effect on our business operations.

10. Use of Proceeds—Perceived Conflicts

A portion of the Net Proceeds may be used to repay or pre-pay certain loans availed by our Company from, amongst others, HDFC Bank Limited, Axis Bank Limited and Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited. While HDFC Bank Limited is one of our Book Running Lead Managers and Axis Bank Limited and Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited are affiliates of certain Book Running Lead Managers, these loans were sanctioned in the ordinary course of business and are not considered a conflict under applicable SEBI regulations. The Board has selected these facilities for repayment based on commercial considerations. However, the use of Net Proceeds for repayment of such loans may still be perceived as a potential conflict of interest.

11. Audit Qualifications by Statutory Auditor

Our Statutory Auditors have included emphasis of matter for Fiscals 2025 and 2024 and negative remarks in accordance with the Companies (Auditor's Report) Order, 2020 in the audit reports issued on the audited Ind AS financial statements for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 which do not require any corrective adjustments in the Restated Consolidated Financial Information. We cannot assure you that our auditors' reports for any future fiscal periods will not contain qualifications, matters of emphasis or other observations or remarks which could subject us to additional liabilities, due to which our reputation and financial condition may be adversely affected.

Continued on next page...

QUICKLY.

Ashok Leyland ties up with Shriram Automall

ITC ‘rearchitected’ cigarette portfolio to offset tax increase

Buffett indicator signals that India’s stock market is relatively less overheated



Chennai: Ashok Leyland signed a memorandum of understanding, with Shriram Automall India. The companies will set up a robust and transparent ecosystem for certified pre-owned commercial vehicles. OUR BUREAU

Hyundai Q2 sees 21% fall in operating profit

Seoul: Hyundai Motor reported a 21 per cent fall in Q2 operating profit, missing analysts’ estimates, as weaker vehicle sales, production disruptions and higher costs outweighed support from a weaker won. Hyundai posted operating profit of 2.9 trillion won (\$1.98 billion) for the April-June period. Its revenue rose 2 per cent from a year earlier to 49.2 trillion won. It forecasts macroeconomic uncertainty will persist. REUTERS

ITC on profitability push to be No. 1 FMCG player: Sanjiv Puri

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

Diversified conglomerate ITC, which aspires to be India’s No. 1 FMCG player, is taking steps to improve profitability for its non-cigarette FMCG business along with growth, going forward. “When successful Indian brands win consumer preference at scale, they retain larger value within the country. That is why ‘Vocal for Local’ is not merely a sentiment; it is a strategy to reinforce domestic capability, create and nurture brands that are born in India but made for the world with impeccable quality and trust that can delight

ITC, the country’s largest cigarette maker, is “rearchitecting” its cigarette portfolio and carrying out “a lot of innovations” to tackle challenges arising from a sharp increase in taxes on cigarettes and various tobacco products, its Chairman and Managing Director Sanjiv Puri said on Thursday. Replying to shareholders’ queries during the diversified conglomerate’s 115th annual general meeting (AGM) on Thursday, Puri said, “We will have some challenges for some time, but we are taking the appropriate steps to deal with the circumstances that have arisen on account of the increase in taxes.” During the AGM, several shareholders raised concerns about a fall in ITC’s share prices after the government substantially increased taxes on cigarettes to around 70 per cent. Allaying their concerns,



TAXING TIMES. Several shareholders raised concerns about a fall in ITC’s share prices after the government substantially increased taxes on cigarettes REUTERS

Puri said, “We have experienced similar instances in the past. Also, on account of taxation, our share price has sometimes been impacted. But the task of the management is always to roll up our sleeves, put our heads down and create value. And the management has successfully done so in the past.” He said to tackle the current challenges of a steep rise in taxation on cigarettes, the company has taken a calibrated approach of pricing to minimise the losses to illicit products. “At the same time, we are rearchitecting the portfolio, and you will see a

lot of innovations in the market, new SKUs. That’s how we are addressing it,” Puri said. He said as far as the longer-term perspective is concerned, ITC’s continuous diversification move is aiming at creating growing value for the shareholders. And the diversification journey has been gathering momentum over time. **NON-CIGARETTE BIZ** According to Puri, when the ITC Next Strategy was launched in 2017, the share of the non-cigarette businesses in the conglomerate’s

bottom line was around 17-18 per cent. Prior to its hotel business demerger in 2025, the share of the non-cigarettes businesses in the bottom line rose up to 25 per cent. “During that period, the bottom line of ITC moved from ₹10,000 crore to ₹20,000 crore, and the share of non-cigarette profits moved from about 18 per cent to 25 per cent. That shows how the other sectors have been progressing, and they’ve been progressing at a faster rate,” Puri said, adding that the company is making large investments in non-cigarette FMCG business, agri business and paperboards, paper & packaging business. He said the non-cigarette FMCG business has emerged as a very big “growth lever” for the company. “We were about ₹10,000 crore in 2017. We are today at ₹24,000 crore (revenue in non-cigarette FMCG business). During this time, margins have also improved by about a per cent or so year-on-year,” Puri said.

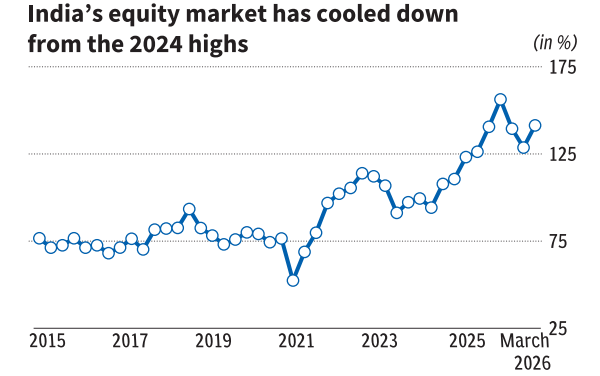
DATA FOCUS.

businessline analysis shows that India’s Buffett indicator has moderated to 111.6 per cent as of March 31, 2026, from the elevated levels seen during 2024-25. Although valuations remain above the long-term average, India is considerably less overheated than several major equity markets, including the US, Taiwan, Japan and South Korea.

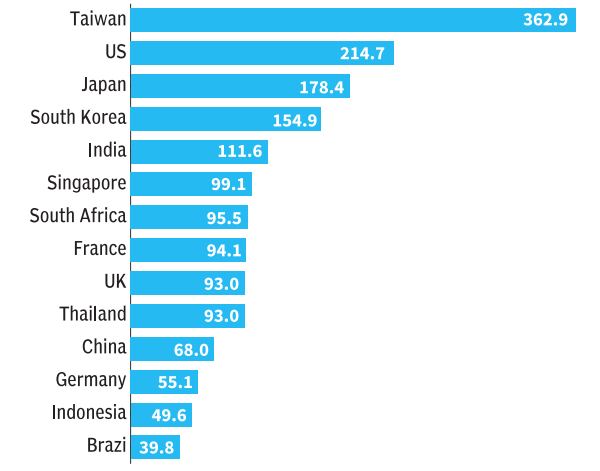
VALUATION PEAKS

India’s Buffett indicator has undergone sharp swings over the past decade, largely reflecting changes in equity market sentiment and economic growth. The ratio stood at 76.6 per cent in June 2015 before declining to 68 per cent by March 2016. It recovered steadily during the following years, reaching 93.4 per cent by December 2017 as equities rallied. The most dramatic movement came during the Covid-19 pandemic. The indicator plunged to 52.4 per cent in March 2020 as market capitalisation fell sharply amid the global sell-off, despite nominal GDP remaining relatively stable. Massive liquidity, improving corporate earnings and a strong post-pandemic recovery then pushed valuations rapidly higher. The ratio crossed 100 per cent in March 2021, and climbed to 114 per cent by September 2021 and, after a brief correction in 2022, it resumed its upward march.

Buffett indicator



India not as overheated as the US, Taiwan, Japan or Korea



Source: Bloomberg

It peaked at 156 per cent in September 2024, when India’s equity market capitalisation reached \$5.68 trillion against a nominal GDP of \$3.63 trillion. Since then, softer equity markets alongside continued expansion in nominal GDP have brought the ratio down to 111.6 per cent by March 2026, indicating that valuations have cooled from their recent highs. **INDIA SITS MID-TABLE** Cross-country data as of March 31, 2026, show that several markets are much more overvalued than India. Market cap to GDP ratio for Taiwan is at 363 per cent, supported by the global dominance of its semiconductor industry, while the US stands at 214.7 per cent, underpinned by the enormous market value of technology giants and sustained investor enthusiasm for artificial intelligence-related companies. Japan at 178.4 per cent and South Korea at 155 per cent also remain significantly above India, reflecting strong export-oriented corporate sectors and globally-competitive manufacturing and technology companies. India’s 111.6 per cent places it below these overheated markets, but above countries such as Singapore at 99 per cent, South Africa at 95.5 per cent, France at 94 per cent and the UK at 93 per cent. While Indian equities continue to command a valuation premium relative to many developed and emerging markets, the excesses visible during the 2024-25 rally have moderated considerably.

Ashiss Kumar Dash to succeed Salil Parekh as MD & CEO at Infosys, to take over from April 1, 2027

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

Infosys has named Ashiss Kumar Dash as CEO-designate. He will succeed current MD and CEO Salil Parekh, who will be completing his second term after more than nine years at the company’s helm, from April 1, 2027. The appointment, recommended by the Board’s Nomination and Remuneration Committee, is subject to shareholder approval and is for a five-year term. Dash will be the third non-promoter CEO in Infosys’ history. Currently EVP & Global Head of Services, Utilities, Resources, Energy & Enterprise Sustainability, Dash oversees Infosys’ third-largest business vertical, which contributes 13.4 per cent of revenue. A 31-year Infosys veteran, he has held leadership roles

across delivery, sales, account management and global operations, and also leads the sustainability business. Dash heads a portfolio spanning more than 12 industry verticals and serves on the boards of Infosys Public Services and MRE Consulting, both wholly-owned subsidiaries. An IIT-Kharagpur alumnus, he has also completed executive programmes at Stanford University and London Business School.

AI TRANSFORMATION Addressing the media during the company’s Q1FY27 earnings conference on Thursday, Nandan Nilekani, Chairman of the Infosys Board, said, “Parekh took the company from \$10 billion to \$20 billion (in revenue), completed the transformation for the digital era and started the AI differentiation



Ashiss Kumar Dash, CEO-designate, Infosys

and transformation.” He added, “The new CEO-designate has worked for 31 years in every part of Infosys. From October 1, Salil will take him on as his mentee and prepare him to manage a complex \$20-billion company at a transformational time.” Dash, currently based in Los Angeles, will relocate to India and undergo mentorship over the next two-three months. \ He also helped set up the Infosys Bhubaneswar Development Centre.

Parekh said, “We have established Infosys as a leader in digital transformation and put in place a distinctive strategy for AI transformation. Dash brings a deep understanding of our clients, business and people, with the vision and capability to lead Infosys through its next phase of transformation.” He added, “The attention is on what we’re driving for this year, making sure that we continue to lead in AI, win market share and have a smooth transition.” Meanwhile, Dash said, “AI is fundamentally reshaping how businesses operate and create value. Infosys begins this next phase with an articulated AI strategy, exceptional talent, deep client relationships and values that have earned the trust of customers globally.”

With inputs from intern Siddhi Patil

OHM losses, cash flow weakness cast shadow on Ashok Leyland’s FY26 profit growth

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Ashok Leyland’s consolidated net profit attributable to owners rose 11.7 per cent to ₹3,471.03 crore in FY26 from ₹3,106.80 crore in FY25. However, a *businessline* analysis of the annual report found pressure in its electric-bus business, weaker operating cash generation and a sharp increase in a loan valuation charge at Hinduja Leyland Finance. The company has responded to the findings from our detailed questionnaire. **OHM LOSS WIDENS** OHM Mobility Solutions’ net loss rose to ₹35.69 crore in FY26 (₹4.60 crore), even as revenue from operations increased to ₹268.23 crore (₹50.37 crore). Finance costs rose to ₹64.84 crore (₹7.82 crore), depreciation

to ₹79.44 crore (₹17.46 crore) and gross debt more than doubled to ₹1,202.59 crore (₹440.55 crore).

The annual report says OHM “now operates a fleet of over 1,400 electric buses across Indian cities”. Responding to queries, the management said: “The GCC model will take slightly longer to achieve PAT breakeven, because of accelerated depreciation of vehicles in its books. However, OHM generated cash profits during FY26.”

OPERATING CASH FLOW

Consolidated net cash inflow from operating activities fell 38.7 per cent to ₹4,792.10 crore (₹7,819.42 crore). The cash contribution from changes in net working capital fell to ₹413.60 crore (₹3,740.68 crore). The annual report says internal accruals funded capex, dividend commitments, loan



repayments and working-capital requirements. It also says Ashok Leyland manages liquidity through “rigorous weekly monitoring of cash flows”. The company attributed the lower cash flow in FY26 to the timing of the ₹1,453-crore interim dividend declared for FY25 and paid during FY26. It also cited higher inventory movement of ₹762 crore and debtor movement of ₹692 crore. “The working capital has increased and hence there was no positive impact on cash due to working capital movement,” it said.

HLFL LOAN VALUATION

The annual report also indicates that the company has booked a ₹1,234.24-crore charge in FY26 to reflect a lower estimated value of loans at Hinduja Leyland Finance (HLFL), up from ₹651 crore in FY25. The charge reduced reported profit, but it was not necessarily a cash payment. “Impairment is related to subsidiary HLFL. Fair valuation of the loan book impact is ₹1,234.24 crore.”

NEW AIRCRAFT

Interestingly, the annual report recorded a new aircraft purchase during FY26 after it replaced an older aircraft that had been in its fleet for about 19 years and sold it for about ₹60 crore. The new aircraft cost ₹435.31 crore in FY26 and had a closing carrying value of ₹423.82 crore after depreciation.

All our vehicles sold since January are E25 compatible: Mercedes-Benz MD

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Luxury carmaker, Mercedes-Benz India, on Thursday, said that all the vehicles — more than 10,000 — it sold since January are E25-compatible and there has been no incidences of any issue with E20 fuel till now, for even cars sold before 2026. “We started with the BSVI transition that happened in 2018 and since 2020, the entire portfolio of Mercedes-Benz in India was E20-compliant. So, I think none of our customers need to worry about the fuel and the future also because, as I said, the future cars are already compliant to the E25 fuel as well as the cars that we sell today are compliant to E25,” Santosh



Santosh Iyer, MD and CEO, Mercedes-Benz India

Iyer, MD and CEO, Mercedes-Benz India, told *businessline* on the sidelines of a launch here.

CAFE-3 NORMS

On the proposals under the Corporate Average Fuel Efficiency (CAFE-3) norms, wherein the government has indicated of carbon trading between companies, Iyer said Mercedes-Benz has a

neutral stand because its portfolio has a mix of petrol, diesel, electric and now plug-in hybrids. “Powertrain choice is a strategic choice by different OEMs. At times, you gain competitive advantage, at times it may not be helpful for meeting certain fuel efficiency norms. As far as we are concerned, we have no issues because we are neutral on this topic; we would comply to any of the new notifications,” he noted. Meanwhile, the company launched its AMG E 53 plug-in hybrid electric vehicle (PHEV) in two editions priced at ₹1.45 crore and ₹1.48 crore, respectively (ex-showroom, all-India), the second hybrid after it launched the S-Class—the S 450 e last month.

JLR previews Range Rover GT electric grand tourer

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) has previewed the Range Rover GT, expanding its portfolio to five core vehicle lines with an all-new fastback grand tourer and the first model based on its Electrified Modular Architecture (EMA).

The announcement came days after JLR previewed the Range Rover Sport Electric, which will bring battery power to its established performance SUV on the flexible MLA platform. The GT will initially be sold as a battery-electric vehicle, with a full-hybrid option planned later. It will be manufactured at JLR’s Halewood plant in the UK alongside ICE and hybrid models. “The Range Rover GT will redefine the grand-touring

segment with the ability to deliver beautiful and engaging GT poise, proportions and long-distance refinement while offering capabilities no conventional GT can match,” Martin Limpert, Managing Director, Range Rover, said. He described it as “the most car-like, yet unmistakably capable, Range Rover ever created”.

INDIA SIGNIFICANCE

The announcement matters to India because Range Rover is JLR’s flagship luxury franchise. It competes with the Mercedes-Benz GLS and Maybach GLS, BMW X7 and Bentley Bentayga. The Range Rover Sport takes on the Porsche Cayenne, BMW X5 and Mercedes-Benz GLE. Range Rover’s advantage is its combination of premium design, bespoke personalisation and cabin



luxury with genuine all-terrain capability. The GT will extend that proposition into a lower, sleeker and more electric grand-touring format.

The Range Rover Sport Electric will offer battery power in an established performance SUV, while the GT introduces a new body style and begins Range Rover’s EMA-based electric line-up. Together, the models give JLR two distinct electric propositions: a performance SUV focused on speed and versatility, and a lower, more

car-like vehicle aimed at long-distance comfort and electric performance.

A NEW DIRECTION

Prototype vehicles are undergoing final global testing. The GT is being developed as a lower, road-focused vehicle rather than an existing SUV converted into an electric derivative. It is designed around comfort, quietness, effortless performance and all-terrain capability. The cabin features a central screen, a driver display replacing the traditional instrument cluster and a concealed air vent running across the dashboard. Woven materials integrate speakers into the interior, while increased second-row legroom is intended to create a calm, low-noise environment. JLR’s House of Brands in-

cludes the Range Rover, Range Rover Sport, Velar and Evoque. MLA will continue to support petrol, diesel, mild-hybrid, plug-in hybrid and battery-electric powertrains. For India, the GT’s eventual arrival would add an electric grand tourer to the luxury family. JLR India sold 6,031 vehicles in FY26, with Range Rover, Range Rover Sport and Defender accounting for over 80 per cent of sales.

businessline.

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QUICKLY.

India, Panama to enhance maritime connectivity



Mumbai: India and Panama are discussing enhancement of maritime connectivity and investments in ports. This comes in the backdrop of West Asia tensions and as India aims to diversify its energy supplies and trade routes. The discussions were held during Panama foreign minister Javier Martinez-Acha Vasquez's New Delhi visit this week. Vasquez held wide ranging discussions with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar. He also interacted with Minister of Ports and Shipping Sarbananda Sonowal and Director General of Maritime Administration Shyam Jagannathan. The bulk of India's crude oil and gas imports transited from the Strait of Hormuz before the start of Iran-US conflict. Since then efforts have been made to diversify the sources. In fact, the US emerged as India's largest LNG supplier in May. The two sides discussed the possibility of developing new shipping services that would help India connect markets in North America and Latin America. ANEESH PHADNIS

To boost exports, govt eases FDI rules for e-comm firms

EXPANDING MARKET. Allows inventory-based models for exporting locally produced goods

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government on Thursday relaxed foreign direct investment (FDI) rules for the e-commerce sector, allowing foreign-funded e-commerce entities to operate inventory-based models exclusively for exports of goods manufactured or produced in India, in a move aimed at expanding overseas market access for sellers.

“In order to facilitate greater exports through easier and increased access of global markets by Indian sellers, the extant FDI policy has been reviewed and it is decided that the restrictions on inventory-based model of e-commerce shall not apply in case of exports of domestically manufactured and/or produced goods/products,” according to Press Note 3 of 2026 notified by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade on Thursday.

The move is expected to enable global e-commerce companies with foreign in-

NEW NORMS

- The move is expected to enable global e-commerce majors Amazon and Flipkart to procure, stock and export Indian-made products directly to overseas consumers
- The revised policy will come into effect from the date of notification under FEMA

vestment, including Amazon and Flipkart, to procure, stock and export Indian-made products directly to overseas consumers, a practice that was not permitted under the existing policy framework.

REVISED POLICY

The revised policy will come into effect from the date of notification under the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), the note added.

Under India's FDI policy, foreign investment is permitted in business-to-business (B2B) e-commerce and marketplace model of e-commerce.

However, FDI is not permitted in business-to-con-

sumer (B2C) e-commerce and inventory-based model of e-commerce where inventory of goods and services is owned by e-commerce entity and is sold to the consumers directly.

Through Press Note 3 of 2026, the restrictions on inventory-based e-commerce and business-to-consumer (B2C) sales under the existing FDI policy will not apply when such platforms export domestically manufactured or produced goods, the press note highlighted.

“The inventory-based e-commerce restriction was originally introduced to regulate domestic retail trading. However, questions had arisen on whether the same restrictions should extend

Oil tops \$100 again after Houthi attack on tankers worsens supply disruption

Reuters
New York



Oil prices climbed above \$100 on Thursday, reaching their highest level in nearly two months,after Yemen's Houthis said they had attacked two Saudi oil tankers in the Red Sea,adding to concerns over global supply disruptions from a near-halt in trade through the Strait of Hormuz.

Brent futures rose \$6.64, or 7 per cent, to \$100.71 a barrel at 10.52 am ET (1452 GMT), exceeding \$100 for the first time since late May. The global crude oil benchmark has risen nearly 40 per cent this month and was in technically overbought territory for a ninth day in a row, the first time since September 2023.

US West Texas Intermediate crude rose \$5.18, or 6 per cent, to \$92.01, trading above \$90 for the first time since June 11. Both contracts were up for the fifth straight day.

“The (Saudi tankers) attack has sent world crude oil prices higher and into a higher gear as the ramifications of yet another chokepoint for crude oil trade originating from the Middle East is constricting trade,”

said Tim Snyder, chief economist at Matador Economics.

SAUDI TANKERS HIT

Yemen's Houthis have opened a new front in the Iran war by targeting vessels carrying Saudi oil in the Bab el-Mandeb Strait after stating they would impose a naval blockade on shipments from Saudi Arabia.

Houthi militia attacked two Saudi Arabian oil tankers in a military operation, the group said on Thursday,with a Saudi news agency later confirming that one of the two vessels was ablaze after an assault while sailing in the Red Sea.

Goldman Sachs said Brent might exceed \$120 a barrel in the fourth quarter and average \$100 next year if the Strait of Hormuz remains disrupted through 2027, with further upside if the Bab el-Mandeb Strait and Suez

Canal also suffer persistent disruption.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said an oil tanker caught fire after an explosion while attempting to follow a mined route in the southern area of the Strait of Hormuz near the coast of Oman and that two others had turned back.

The Guards said the strait was under their control and “completely closed” while US actions continued in the region, warning that no tanker would be allowed to enter or leave without coordination with Iran.

Iranian strikes on vessels crossing the Strait of Hormuz have resulted in a drop in non-Iranian oil tankers traversing the waterway.

At the same time, the reintroduction of a US naval blockade targeting Iranian ports has likely resulted in Iranian oil loadings falling to zero from 1.5 million to 2million barrels per day at the start of the month, Giovanni Staunovo, a UBS analyst, said.

As a result of fewer shipments exiting the strait, loading activity within the Gulf has fallen to 2.5 million bpd over the past seven days, compared with 6 million bpd over the past 30days, he added.

HPCL's under recovery on fuel and LPG hits ₹26,000 crore in April-June quarter

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



Vikas Kaushal, CMD, HPCL

State-run Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL) on Thursday said that its cumulative under recovery on petrol, diesel and liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) stood at around ₹26,000 crore in the April-June quarter as the conflict in West Asia.

Responding to an analyst query at a post-results call, HPCL CMD Vikas Kaushal said: “For the whole quarter, there is a significant under-recovery on this... Just to give you a sense, the marketing under-recovery for the whole quarter was upwards of ₹26,000 crore... It was a significant under-recovery for the whole quarter. Every litre which you and I were buying from petrol pump was being subsidised by one of the three OMCs.”

HPCL reported a consolidated net loss of around ₹12,265 crore in Q1 FY27 as the West Asia conflict pushed up crude oil prices while PSU OMCs sold petrol, diesel and LPG at below market cost impacting margins.

Due to the closure of the

Strait of Hormuz (SoH), crude oil prices surged as West Asian cargoes got stranded. Besides, it also impacted supply of LPG and LNG with India among the major impacted countries. PSU oil marketing companies (OMCs) have incurred high under recoveries as they sold petrol, diesel and LPG at below market rates.

The OMC attributed the impact to suppressed marketing margins on certain petroleum products.

According to Equirus Securities, the average Brent price:stood at \$97 per barrel, an over 25 per cent growth Q-o-Q and around 45 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1 FY27. The average Saudi propane prices stood at \$682 per tonne,

growing by over 26 per cent Q-o-Q and over 17 per cent Y-o-Y.

HPCL's under recoveries on LPG as on June 30, 2026 were around ₹16,405.92 crore, against ₹12,798.67 crore as of March 31, 2026 and ₹13,042.56 crore on June 30, 2025.

LPG LOSS

To another analyst query, Kaushal said that for the entire Q1 FY27, HPCL's LPG loss stood at around ₹510 per cylinder. The loss is around ₹680 crore in June 2026 and ₹490 per cylinder in July 2026.

HPCL's standalone and consolidated debt increased sharply by ₹ 25,000 crore Q-o-Q to ₹72,600 crore and ₹75,900 crore, respectively. Increase reflects significant working-capital and funding burden created by elevated crude costs and marketing under-recoveries, Equirus added.

The HPCL management said that debt reduction is a top priority, with a goal of bringing the debt-to-equity ratio back toward 0.8 over time. The OMC has also initiated measures to optimise

its operations through project Samridhii. In FY26, HPCL launched Samridhii 1.0, which is a structured EBITDA improvement programme that delivered accruals of ₹1,691 crore.

Building on this success, HPCL has now launched Samridhii 2.0, an enterprise-wide programme targeting at an EBITDA improvement by ₹1,500 crore, out of which ₹1,000 crore is targeted as accrual for FY27.

HPCL Spokesperson said: “The first quarter of FY27 presented a challenging operating environment, with heightened geopolitical uncertainties and volatility in global energy markets. Throughout this period, HPCL remained focused on its core responsibility of ensuring uninterrupted availability of petroleum products and LPG across the country.

“Our integrated refining, supply chain and marketing network demonstrated resilience and operational agility, enabling us to maintain reliable supplies while undertaking targeted measures to augment LPG production.”

CPCL posts ₹1,031 cr profit on stronger refining margins

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai



H Shankar, MD

Chennai Petroleum Corporation Ltd (CPCL) reported a consolidated net profit of ₹1,031 crore for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, (Q1FY27) against a net loss of ₹40 crore in the corresponding quarter last year.

Sequentially, however, profit declined from ₹1,421 crore reported in the March quarter. Revenue for the June quarter rose 57 per cent to ₹29,359 crore from ₹18,683 crore a year ago.

CPCL's average Gross Refining Margin (GRM) nearly tripled to \$8.78 per barrel during April-June 2026 from \$3.22 per barrel a year earlier, excluding a one-time revenue adjustment.

The company also recognised ₹385 crore as additional revenue during the quarter following the retrospective revision in petroleum product prices effective March 16, 2026, relating to supplies made during March.

Managing Director H Shankar said the refinery's operational performance was the highlight of the quarter as the company sustained throughput above rated capacity despite severe

constraints in sourcing Middle East crude.

The company achieved a crude throughput of 2.85 million tonnes. The company also recorded its highest-ever distillate yield, reflecting improved operational efficiency, a statement read.

“We maintained 108 per cent capacity utilisation during a difficult geopolitical period when supplies of Middle East crude had almost dried up, forcing the company to rely largely on Russian and African crude,” he told *businessline*.

STRONGER CRACKS

Explaining the turnaround from a loss in the year-ago quarter, Shankar said the biggest driver was stronger refining economics.

“The main reason was favourable product pricing and very strong refining cracks - the difference between refined product prices and crude oil costs- available for

standalone refiners. The higher product prices also helped lift revenue during the quarter, he said.

However, the quarter was not without challenges.

Compared to the March quarter when crude was around \$80 per barrel, crude procurement costs increased sharply, with average crude prices nearing \$100 per barrel, the MD pointed out.

In addition, discounts on crude largely disappeared, while Russian and African crudes carried premium prices along with higher freight and insurance costs, said Shankar. The company benefited from lower excise duty following the reduction in central excise on petrol and diesel from March 27, resulting in a lower excise outgo during the quarter.



No discounts on Russian oil for Sept deliveries: BPCL

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

State-run Bharat Petroleum Corporation (BPCL) said on Thursday that traders have stopped offering discounts on Russian crude oil for delivery in September 2026.

The development comes as the Houthi rebels have threatened to block the Bab al-Mandab Strait and have attacked a couple of vessels carrying Saudi crude, pushing Brent again past the \$100 per barrel on Thursday.

However, the company has contracted crude oil supplies for July and August 2026 and has also booked a couple of cargoes for delivery in September.

In a post-results analyst call, VRK Gupta, Director (Finance) at BPCL, said, “Till August we have completed the deals, including Russian Urals and ESPO. September offers are coming. We have to wait, may be next one week, we will come to know what will be the discount scenario. But, definitely based on the recent development in the crude market now no one is offering any discount for Russian crude.” Pointing out the uncertainty regarding the end of the conflict in West Asia,

he noted that markets witnessed a brief period of stability in June.

RED SEA RISKS PERSIST

“Based on recent issues in the Red Sea route, there may be certain issues in terms of couple of cargoes, but otherwise we have sufficient crude oil till August 31, 2026. Maintaining 30 days of crude also. September window has opened. Couple of cargoes we have booked. Maybe in the next 7-10 days, we will complete the deals for September. No visibility beyond September,” Gupta said.

On navigating the West Asia conflict during Q1 FY27, he said that due to disruptions in tied-up term crude volumes, BPCL proactively optimised its crude sourcing by significantly increasing spot crude purchases, with spot percentage rising to almost 69 per cent in Q1 FY27 from 44 per cent in the corresponding previous year.

“We diversified our crude sourcing outside of the Hormuz, exploring multiple geographies, including increasing the Russian crude grades to 38 per cent of our total procurement during this quarter. We procured two crude grades from Venezuela and Angola,” Gupta added.

India faces scrutiny over tariffs, MSP, quality control steps at WTO review

Amiti Sen
New Delhi



India came under sustained scrutiny from several WTO members during its eighth trade policy review (TPR), with countries raising concerns over “abrupt tariff changes”, quality control measures, agricultural restrictions, the MSP regime, industrial subsidies and New Delhi's stance on key plurilateral initiatives.

In concluding remarks issued on Thursday after the two-day review, Chairperson Ambassador Nella Pepe Tavita-Levy said transparency and predictability emerged as the foremost concerns raised by members, even as they acknowledged India's growing importance in the global economy and supported its ambition of becoming a developed nation by 2047.

The review attracted significant participation, with India receiving more than 1,090 written questions from 44 WTO members, over 700 of which were answered before the meeting. Representatives of 68 members spoke during the two-day review.

“Foremost among members' concerns, both ex-

pressed in prior questions and made in statements in the last two days, were predictability and transparency,” Tavita-Levy said.

Members flagged what they described as abrupt tariff changes, unexpected export restrictions, complex licensing procedures, lengthy investment approval processes and an overall lack of regulatory certainty.

QUALITY CONTROL

India's expanding use of Quality Control Orders (QCOs) also drew extensive scrutiny. While countries acknowledged New Delhi's efforts to improve product quality and consumer protection, they sought greater clarity on consultation procedures, delays in factory inspections, implementation timelines, conformity assessment requirements and recognition of foreign testing laboratories “Members highlighted the burden delays placed on their ex-

porters and the importance of transparency, proportionality, and predictability,” Tavita Levy said.

In the area of agriculture, concerns were raised on India's minimum support price (MSP) regime, public stockholding programme, input subsidies, tariff administration and recurring export restrictions on commodities such as rice, wheat, sugar and onions. “Questions were directed at the transparency, predictability, WTO consistency and notification of these measures, as well as their potential trade-distorting effects. Members also highlighted concerns about sanitary and phytosanitary (SPS) measures, including relating to the availability of underlying risk assessments and related methodologies, food safety standards, pesticide maximum residue limits, and procedures for judging equivalence for SPS measures,” she said.

“A large number of members also encouraged India to lift its objections to the incorporation of new plurilateral arrangements into WTO legal texts through Annex 4, in particular as regards the Investment Facilitation for Development Agreement,” the Chairperson said.

GMR		GMR Pochanpalli Expressways Limited			
Reg Off: 25/1, SKIP House, Museum Road, Bengaluru – 560 025, India, T : + 91 80 40432000, F : + 91 80 40432323					
Email ID: highways.secre@gmrgroup.in , W:www.gmrgroup.com		CIN: U45200KA2005PLC049327			
Unaudited Financial Results for quarter ended June 30, 2026					
(Regulation 52 (B) read with Regulation 52 (4) of the Listing Regulations)					
		(₹ in Lakhs)			
Sl no	Particulars	Quarted ended		Year ended	
		30-Jun-26	30-Jun-25	31-Mar-26	31-Mar-25
		Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited	Audited
1	Total Income from Operations	2,798.69	2,731.73	10,425.47	10,425.47
2	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	293.99	476.82	1,235.97	2,335.97
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	293.99	476.82	1,235.97	2,335.97
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	130.20	298.62	1,979.21	1,979.21
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	156.89	276.98	1,954.77	1,954.77
6	Paid-up equity share capital (Face Value of ₹10 each)	13,800.00	13,800.00	13,800.00	13,800.00
7	Reserves (excluding revaluation reserve) (as per latest audited financials)	-	-	18,514.99	-
8	Securities Premium Account	-	-	-	-
9	Net-worth (refer note no.4)	23,212.44	21,377.76	23,055.55	-
10	Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt (including interest accrued thereon) (refer note no.4)	2,322.49	7,296.55	5,182.81	-
11	Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares (refer note no.4)	4,319.55	3,902.65	4,211.62	-
12	Debt Equity Ratio (refer note no.4)	0.21	0.37	0.30	-
13	Earning Per Share (EPS) of ₹10/- each (for continuing and discontinued operations) – (not annualised for the quarters)	-	-	-	-
1. Basic		0.09	0.22	1.43	-
2. Diluted		0.09	0.22	1.43	-
14	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-
15	Debtenture Redemption Reserve	9,259.44	9,259.44	9,259.44	-
16	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (refer note no.4)	0.33	0.49	0.56	-
17	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (refer note no.4)	6.52	3.79	5.13	-

Notes:

1. The aforesaid financial results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on July 22, 2026. The above financial results have been prepared as per the format prescribed in Regulation 52(B) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 as amended.

2. The above is the extract of the detailed format of quarterly financial results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52 of the Listing Regulation. The full format of the quarterly financial results are available on the websites of the National Stock Exchange (www.nseindia.com) and listed entity (www.gmrgroup.com).

3. For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4), 52(7), 52(7A) and 54(3) of the Listing regulations, pertinent disclosures have been made to the National Stock Exchange and can be accessed on the their www.nseindia.com and listed entity www.gmrgroup.com.

4. The Company has computed the following ratios based on financial statements prepared and certified by the management of the Company as per Generally Accepted Accounting Practices in India (previous GAAP / ICAAP) without giving effect to Ind AS adjustments. Formulae used for computation of ratios are as follows:

i. Net worth : Share Capital plus other equities less Debtenture Redemption Reserve, As per ICAAP workings, The net worth shall be ₹33,434.70 Lakhs for the period/ year ended June 30, 2026 (March 31, 2026 : ₹32,408.70 Lakhs).

ii. Paid-up debt capital represents outstanding non-convertible Debtentures (secured debt) including accrued interest thereon.

iii. Unlisted Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares are disclosed only to the extent of liability portion of outstanding preference shares as per Ind AS Financial statements.

iv. Debt / Equity Ratio : [(Debt means secured debt + interest accrued on secured debt + liability portion of preference shares + lease liability) / (Equity Share Capital plus other equities including debtenture redemption reserve and equity component of preference shares)]

Debt / Equity Ratio as per ICAAP Financials : [(Debt means secured debt + interest accrued on secured debt) / (Equity Share Capital plus other equities)]

As per ICAAP workings, the Debt Equity ratio shall be: 0.06 times for the period/year ended June 30, 2026 (March 31, 2026 : 0.14 times).

v. Debt Service Coverage Ratio (DSCR) : (Earnings before Tax + Depreciation + Interest on secured debts and lease liability) / (Interest on secured debts and lease liability + Interest on secured debts and lease liability during the period/year). As per ICAAP workings, the DSCR shall be: 1.74 times for the period/year ended June 30, 2026 (March 31, 2026 : 1.40 times).

vi. Interest Service Coverage Ratio (ISCR) : (Earnings before Tax + Depreciation + Interest on secured debt and lease liability/ Interest on secured debts and lease liability). As per ICAAP workings, the ISCR shall be: 36.04 times for the period/year ended June 30, 2026 (March 31, 2026 : 12.95 times).

vii. For the purpose of debt coverage and interest service coverage ratio, liability portion of preference shares and unwinding interest on liability portion of preference shares are not considered.

5. Previous quarter/period/year figures and ratios are recalculated where applicable.

Place : New Delhi
Date : July 22, 2026

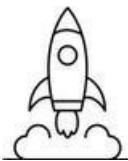
For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of
GMR Pochanpalli Expressways Limited
-Sd-
Ramadevi Bommidala
Whole Time Director (DIN 00575031)

GMR GROUP - PE/44/PREM ASSOCIATES

Launching pad

Vikram-1 can be turned into a commercial success

Skyroot Aerospace’s successful launch of Vikram-1 is a moment of pride for India. For the first time, an Indian private company has demonstrated that it can build and fly an orbital-class launch vehicle. The mission has done more than place a payload in space; it has drawn global attention to India’s emerging private space capabilities.



Space is not merely about satellites and rockets; it is also about prestige, strategic capability and the confidence that a nation can compete in one of the most demanding technology sectors. But building a rocket is not the same as building a rocket business. Space history is full of companies that demonstrated technological capability but struggled to create sustainable commercial enterprises. The reasons are familiar: high development costs, limited launch windows, intense competition and the unforgiving economics of reliability. A rocket company must launch repeatedly, on schedule and at a cost customers are willing to pay. The opportunity is certainly large. The demand for satellite launches is expected to grow rapidly, driven by communications, Earth observation, defence and scientific missions. But the market is also becoming increasingly crowded. New entrants are entering a sector whose economics have already been transformed by companies such as SpaceX.

SpaceX’s advantage comes not merely from building rockets, but from changing the cost structure of launch. Recovering and reusing the first stage has dramatically improved economics, while rideshare missions allow multiple customers to share launch costs. Any new launch provider must therefore compete not only on technology but also on price and flexibility. Vikram-1 relies on proven solid-fuel propulsion, a technology valued for its simplicity, reliability and long shelf life. But solid rocket stages are not designed for recovery and reuse. Globally, the small payload launch industry is moving towards a model where the first stage is recovered and reused, while the upper stage performs the final orbital injection. Whether and how Skyroot adapts to this emerging paradigm will influence its long-term competitiveness.

There are commercial constraints. Vikram-1 is a large, four-stage solid-fuel rocket. While this brings advantages, it may limit some overseas opportunities because such systems can face restrictions on international movement and exports. The addressable market may therefore be smaller than the headline global satellite numbers suggest. One opportunity Skyroot should actively pursue is defence. A capable launch vehicle has clear strategic value, and a rocket platform can potentially serve dual purposes — with suitable modifications, carrying defence payloads instead of commercial satellites. None of these concerns diminishes Skyroot’s achievement. The company has crossed a barrier few private firms worldwide have managed to overcome. The message after Vikram-1, however, should be clear: the rocket has been built. Now comes the harder mission — building a business.

POCKET RAVIKANTH



Pitfalls of FCNR (B) scheme

DOLLAR DILEMMA. In trying to attract capital inflows, we may end up undermining external account stability



SMITA ROY TRIVEDI
ABHIMAN DAS

The long ranging ramifications of the new arsenal in RBI’s toolkit, the FCNR(B) deposits could be serious. The scheme by itself is straightforward: garner NRI dollar deposits, strengthen reserves, thereby prevent rupee depreciation. Estimates put the amount of capital inflow expected to exceed \$50 billion (Reuters, June 5, 2026), though initial response has been less than \$18 billion. However, several facets of the scheme have important repercussions for future rupee strength.

In trying to attract capital inflows, are we mortgaging the future? Former RBI Deputy Governor SS Tarapore once remarked that “providing exchange rate guarantees” is a sin for central banks (*Business Standard*, October 25 1997). In our bid to support the rupee, have we implicitly promised an exchange rate trajectory?

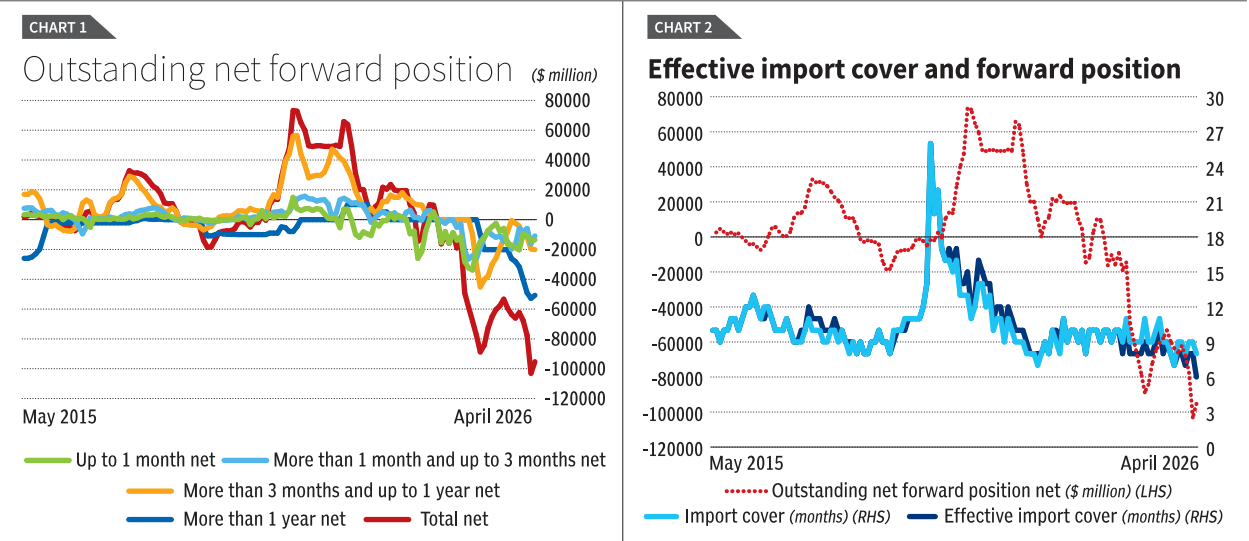
WHO GAINS?
First, to make the scheme lucrative for the NRI, ceilings on interest rates have been removed (RBI, June 17, 2026) — some banks are offering an interest rate as high as 7.5 per cent on FCNR(B) deposits, significantly above the domestic deposit rates.

Second, the leverage permitted by RBI (RBI FAQ, June 23, 2026) allows customers to take loans against these deposits, with leverage being offered anywhere between nine and 19 times presently to attract deposits (Bloomberg and banks’ inputs). Conservatively, an NRI with a \$1 million deposit can borrow \$9 million against it, investing \$10 million, earning 7.5 per cent on the total investment (see Table).

Third, for banks, the deposits (though not the interest payments) are hedged against future depreciation, with the central bank bearing the hedging cost (RBI, June 8, 2026).

Finally, as banks in India are struggling to mobilise deposits, this is a much-needed source of funding: every dollar swapped with the RBI provides approximately ₹95 of rupee liquidity that can be deployed for domestic lending (see Table).

THE CONCERNS
First, for both NRIs and banks, the success of the scheme depends on the possibility of leverage. To obtain the funds for leverage, the domestic banks are borrowing from overseas markets. With a large number of Indian banks



Source: RBI Database, Authors’ calculations

Comparative costs and benefits for stakeholders

Impact/ stakeholder	NRI customer	Bank (India)	RBI
Modus operandi and first order impact	- Deposits \$1 million earning approx.6-7.5% p.a. - Uses this deposit as collateral to borrow from banks (leverage between 9 and 19 times) - In effect, invests \$10 million (assuming \$9 million borrowing) - Earns 6-7.5% on an FCNR(B), borrowing at around 5.6% - Spread of 1.4%, with 9-19 times leverage means a >20% returns on the investor’s own equity	- Raises the leveraged \$9 million through overseas funding (assumed cost of approx. 5.6%). Pays around 7% p.a. on the FCNR(B) - Deploys rupee liquidity into domestic lending - Net margin depends on the combined cost of overseas funding, interest paid to depositors, and concessional RBI swap	- Receives \$10 billion into forex reserves - Rupee liquidity increases domestically - Bears hedging cost

Source: Authors

accessing the global markets to avail of dollar funding, the lending cost is being pushed up. An increase in borrowing costs in global markets puts pressure on the margins for Indian banks. Moreover, banks must deploy the funds successfully as these deposits are priced higher than domestic deposits.

SS Tarapore, the former RBI Deputy Governor, elucidated the three sins of central banking: paying interest on CRR balances, providing exchange guarantees, and low-cost automatic monetisation of the fiscal deficit

Second, of greater concern is the central bank’s balance sheet. The FCNR(B) inflow today will be converted into an outflow of dollars five years down the line. Even with an optimistic estimate that the RBI will have enough reserves in future, it is nevertheless a promise to provide dollars in the future. Implicitly, the central bank is committing to meeting future dollar demand, effectively increasing dollar dependence.

Third, RBI will have a growing short dollar book, already inflated with interventions till date (Chart 1). The FCNR inflows will take care of the present concerns, pushing short position to future. If we calculate the RBI’s net short forward commitments as a percentage of reserves, it has increased substantially, amounting to close to 20 per cent of Foreign Currency Assets

CJP-led Gen Z protests in a nutshell

The call for accountability over NEET exam leaks refuses to die down. Resignation of the education minister is a key demand

bl.explainer

Ramasamy Jayaprakash

How did the uprising start?

The immediate trigger for the protests was the alleged paper leak for the NEET-UG 2026 medical entrance exams that were held on May 3 and the subsequent cancellation of the exam. Between the exam and the re-test that was ordered, 12 students committed suicide due to stress and trauma.

While there was widespread anger about this, during a hearing on May 15, Chief Justice of India Surya Kant made a remark about young people. “There are youngsters like cockroaches, who don’t get any employment and don’t have any place in the profession.

Some of them become media, some of them become social media, RTI activists and other activists, and they start attacking everyone.” The remark led to a spontaneous outburst of satirical posts on social media which was the beginning of the political movement ‘Cockroach Janata Party’ (CJP).

It hit the streets on June 6 in various parts of the country demanding accountability for exam leaks. After the initial isolated protests

across the country, CJP regrouped and started an indefinite sit-in protest on June 20 at Jantar Mantar.

Sonam Wangchuk, who in mid-May announced himself as an honorary cockroach when CJP was formed, joined the protests on June 28 and started an indefinite fast.

On July 18 police moved him to hospital after his condition deteriorated; he was later shifted to another facility on court orders.

On July 20, a planned march to Parliament was thwarted by the police.

What are the main demands of the protestors?

The central demand of the CJP is the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan for allegedly repeated failures in the integrity of national examinations and several paper leaks. They also seek compensation for affected students and the families of those who died by suicide, in addition to broader reforms to make the exam system more transparent and accountable.

Who is participating in the agitation?

The protest is overwhelmingly youth- and student-led. Specifically, aspirants



AGITATION. Gathering strength

of competitive exams (NEET and other similar entrance tests) and Gen Z. Student groups, parents of aspirants and some civil-society figures have either joined or expressed solidarity for the CJP-led protest. Some opposition parties have also extended their support.

What has been the government’s response so far?

The government’s response was stern to begin with. The police *lathi* charged the protestors during their march to Parliament and allegedly used pellet guns resulting in severe injuries and as many as 70 being detained.

However, the police have denied any usage of pellet guns and claimed over

(FCA). In other words, around 80 per cent of the reported FCA remains unencumbered for future intervention.

As the RBI’s short dollar position expands, its contingent foreign currency liabilities swell: as BIS (2019) argues reserve adequacy needs to be assessed after accounting for the overall foreign currency position. Experience from South Africa, for example, suggests how large forward dollar commitments effectively weaken reserve buffer (BIS, 2019, p.6, 252-253).

We compare the Import Cover (Foreign currency Assets/ Average Monthly Merchandise Imports) with an Effective Import Cover [(Foreign Currency Assets–Net Short Forward Position)/ Average Monthly Merchandise Imports in months] in Chart 2. In recent months, effective import cover has fallen as we have intervened in spot and forward markets. With the FCNR deposit inflows, the short dollar book of RBI will further increase, impacting the effective reserve adequacy.

SS Tarapore, the former RBI Deputy Governor, a vociferous supporter of central bank autonomy and the architect of India’s baby steps into capital account convertibility, elucidated the three sins of central banking: paying interest on CRR balances, providing exchange guarantees, and low-cost automatic monetisation of the fiscal deficit.

In the FCNR-like schemes however, the central bank bears cost of regulatory requirements and implicitly promises future dollars. Are we then securing the present, with a mortgage on the future, and prioritising the exchange rate trajectory over monetary policy concerns?

Trivedi is Associate Professor, National Institute of Bank Management, and Das is ICICI Bank Chair Professor, IIM Ahmedabad. Views are personal

Is this akin to uprisings in Nepal and Bangladesh recently?

The protests in Bangladesh in 2024 began over a new job-quota system to favour the loyalists of the ruling-party. The Gen Z uprising in Nepal in September 2025 was sparked by a ban on social media.

The protests in Bangladesh and Nepal also triggered the long-entrenched deep anger over corruption, systemic issues, and unemployment. Both these rapidly turned into calls for regime change, and led to the resignation of the top leaders.

The protests in India, on the contrary, have remained more focused on accountability in issues pertaining to exams and education. There are no calls to overthrow the government.

● **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Student protests

This refers to ‘Broken system’ (July 23). It was disgusting to witness the brutality of police action against peaceful protesters, predominantly young people, demanding the resignation of the Union Education Minister, Dharmendra Pradhan. The largely voluntary and swift turnout of protesters from various States to the national capital was an organic outburst of their frustration and discontent. The government has clearly failed to adequately address the concerns of millions of students

and parents over repeated paper leaks and other systemic failures in the conduct of crucial examinations. The sordid episode serves as a cautionary signal to the establishment not to procrastinate on issues of utmost public importance.

Kamal Laddha
Bengaluru

Aviation reforms

Appropos, ‘Government plans aviation reforms to spur new airlines’ (July 23). India’s aviation sector is

increasingly characterised by a near-duopoly, raising concerns about competition, pricing, and consumer welfare. Excessive market concentration can lead to higher airfares, limited choices, and reduced incentives for innovation and service improvement. Given aviation’s critical role in economic development and regional connectivity, policymakers must introduce reforms that encourage the entry of new airlines. Easier access to capital, rationalised taxes,

improved infrastructure, and a transparent regulatory framework can foster greater competition. A more diversified aviation market would enhance efficiency, strengthen resilience, improve passenger services, and support the sector’s long-term sustainable growth.

N Sadhasiva Reddy
Bengaluru

Healthcare protectionism

The US proposal to impose 100 per cent and 200 per cent tariffs on

imported generic medicines by 2028 is reckless healthcare protectionism disguised as national security. India, the pharmacy of the world, exported \$9.7 billion in pharmaceuticals to the US in 2025 accounting for 38 per cent of its global exports. Prioritising isolationist economics over global health cooperation is an alarming policy blunder that risks weaponising essential medicine at the ultimate cost of human life.

Vijaykumar HK
Raichur, Karnataka



Risks in financing AI

Financial guardrails needed to curb AI exuberance

Abhinav Jindal
Vaibhavi Singh

While the AI boom will change the world for the better, is the world financing that change wisely?

Governments across the globe are setting up dedicated AI funds. Companies are racing to put AI into everything from customer service to healthcare to manufacturing. Investors are also pouring money into Data centres, Chips, and AI companies.

In June 2025, the Bank for International Settlements (BIS) in its annual report with an unusually direct warning: AI valuations may have climbed beyond what current earnings justify; much of the investment is funded by borrowed money; and the physical infrastructure AI depends on is more fragile and concentrated than most realise.

More recently in June 2026, the BIS sharpened that warning, flagging circular financing among hyperscalers like Amazon, Google or Microsoft and growing non-bank exposure.

This brings forth a key question — whether this AI boom may turn into a global risk which deserves more attention than what it is getting.

IS AI VALUED CORRECTLY? Technology companies like Nvidia and Apple, mostly US based, make up a surprisingly large share of global stock market value. They are priced not on what they earn today but on what investors expect once AI is fully embedded in the economy. This gap is what some economists term as stretched valuations.

Much of this investment rests on borrowed money or leveraged investing, in the BIS' own words. Debt magnifies gains and losses, and when things go wrong, the damage spreads from the original investor to whoever lent the money, and then to whoever lent them money in turn, a dynamic seen before in the dot-com crash and the 2008 housing collapse.

The Financial Stability Board has also highlighted the AI led financial stability implications which go beyond the financial institutions to manifest itself as a systemic risk.

These can be traced back to four main channels: first-concentration risk-reliance on a few AI service providers, whose outages would ripple across institutions; second — herding i.e. a financial risk, as banks lean on similar models, correlating trading and lending;



AI. Financial pitfalls /ISTOCKPHOTO

third — cyber risk and fourth — opaque model risks emanating from data quality and governance issues, complicating supervision.

For countries like India, the stakes are real and direct. India also shares this optimism and looks to benefit from AI-driven productivity.

But, as in the past, when global markets have tumbled, emerging economies like India were the first to feel the hit with investments flowing out, currencies weakening and borrowing costs rising. In case of any AI led financial contagion, India should not expect to be spared just because it is not at the centre of the AI boom.

AI could also potentially raise inflation with data centres pushing up demand for electricity, competition for AI talent lifting salaries, forcing central banks to rise policy rates.

Clearly, the tools central banks across the world had, were not built for a moment when one technology could reshape prices and markets at once and at large. A few, including the RBI, have begun exploring AI-specific stress-testing, but such efforts remain early-stage and voluntary.

AI is here to stay and there is no denying its potential. But the challenge is to build the right foundations around it: stronger financial oversight, diversified supply chains, resilient energy infrastructure, and monetary policy anchored to price stability rather than market enthusiasms.

India appears to be moving in that direction, with a proposed law built on graded, risk-based rules and stricter obligations for AI in banking and finance. Governments and regulators must ensure that the AI boom becomes a foundation for long-term prosperity, not the source of tomorrow's crisis.

Jindal is a Senior Faculty and an Economist; Singh studies Economics at Shiv Nadar University



R KRISHNA KUMAR

Every July, countless parents convert their living and dining areas into counselling spaces. Topics like cut-off marks, college rankings, and placement stats become common talk. At the heart of these discussions are the questions: Which course? And which college?

However, when rushing to pick a seat, we often forget a crucial factor. The choice a student makes today is not just for the next four years. That teenager will grow into a young professional, then a middle-aged leader, and perhaps a senior industry leader. All these future stages are connected to the decision made at age 18.

Educators and policymakers must consider whether they are preparing students for the world they will live in over the next 50 years, or training them for a world that is becoming obsolete.

The upcoming half-century of engineering will be shaped by five key national missions: Agricultural advancements, medical innovations, mobility solutions, manufacturing development, and energy progress.

Agricultural technology: With nearly 40 per cent of the workforce engaged in agriculture, innovations such as precision farming, IoT-based soil and water management, automated equipment, AI-driven pest control, climate analytics, digital markets, supply chain analysis, and advanced food processing are transforming farming into a high-tech sector. These developments demand engineers skilled in electronics, sensors, AI, data science, and systems engineering. Agricultural technologists play a vital role similar to medical technologists. Engineering institutions should focus on training future leaders in agricultural innovation.

Medical innovations: The medical equipment industry manufactures MRI machines, CT scanners, stents and more, and exports to over 180 countries. Yet, India still imports 75 per cent of medical equipment, highlighting a contradiction.

The core issue lies in education: Our outdated medical instrumentation curriculum has not evolved. Medicine is inherently specialised, and medical technologies should also be so. Students graduate without ever learning the engineering of robotic surgery, image-guided interventions, implantable cardiac devices, orthopaedic implants, or point-of-care devices. While the industry expects engineers to be ready immediately, educational institutes rarely prepare students for this. Apart from one or two IIT courses, there's little focus on preparing students for the future of medicine.

Mobility solutions: Historically,



GETTY IMAGES

Producing engineers for a changing world

TECH AGENDA. We need to train engineers to work in the fields of agriculture, medical tech, mobility and energy

engineering was divided into mechanical, civil, and electrical fields. Over time, technologies became mission-driven rather than discipline-driven.

For example, mobility has emerged as a new discipline that integrates mechanical, electronic, battery, hydrogen, and other technologies. Modern mobility spans power electronics, batteries, autonomous driving, hydrogen vehicles, and connected cars. The links between traditional sectors such as automotive, aeronautics, and locomotion are seldom recognised. For example, hydrogen train technology can be applied to hydrogen trucks. Electric locomotion has existed long before the widespread adoption of EVs.

Our automotive education is heavily based on aerospace textbooks, and vehicle dynamics derive from aircraft principles. Despite being a top car manufacturer and a major EV hub, we lack specialised mobility engineering

Given the country's huge reliance on imports for medical equipment, it is vital to create courses for medical technology in our engineering colleges

courses for an undergraduate education.

Manufacturing development: I spoke with a parent working in manufacturing who was urgently seeking a course for his child. Our conversation shifted to his work, and he shared how manufacturing has transformed significantly since the Industrial Revolution. He mentioned that the factory of the future won't be just a bunch of machines, but a cyber-physical system influenced by Industry 4.0 and 5.0, digital twins, and additive manufacturing. He looked excited when discussing these ideas.

I recommended finding a course to prepare his child for this evolving landscape, but surprisingly, no such course exists. Despite manufacturing contributing 17 per cent to our GDP, there is still no comprehensive undergraduate programme in the field.

Energy progress: A conversation with an economist unexpectedly concluded with a simple truth: Energy is fundamental to every sector of the economy.

From factories and data centres to metro systems and electric vehicles, much of our daily life depends on energy. Today, India is the third-largest producer and consumer of electricity worldwide. It ranks fourth globally in renewable energy capacity, third in solar, and is also making large investments in

green hydrogen, battery storage, small nuclear power plants, and carbon capture technologies.

But where can a young person find a clear path to prepare for the future? Unfortunately, there is none.

In 1947, India tasked engineers with producing iron and steel and building bridges as it began establishing itself internationally. But by 2047, the nation will require engineers skilled in creating autonomous farms, intelligent healthcare, clean energy, and cyber-physical systems.

Currently, India organises its ministries around specific missions, aligning industry and research funding with these goals. However, engineering education still largely follows 19th-century frameworks.

For any sector to thrive, programmes must span from research to undergraduate training. It is essential to develop strong undergraduate programmes in Agricultural Technologies, Mobility, Manufacturing, Medical Technology, and Energy, in addition to research, to support this growth.

Curricula should increasingly focus on national priorities and strategies over traditional departmental boundaries.

The writer is Institute Professor, Indian Institute of Technology Madras

thehindubusinessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO **TODAY.**

July 24, 2006

Exim Bank picks 10% stake in Tata Coffee's US venture

Exim Bank of India has picked up 10 per cent stake in the Consolidated Coffee Inc — the special purpose vehicle of Tata Coffee for acquisition of US based Eight O'Clock Coffee Company. "We have participated with Tata Coffee for acquisition of the US-based coffee company. We have taken 10 per cent equity stake with investment of \$5 million," said Mr T.C. Ventak Subramanian.

Foreign funds fuel domestic realty boom

The booming Indian property market could be in for a sustained bull run. Propelled by shortfall of around 20 million homes in the country, an estimated \$10-12 billion of investment has been pledged by foreign and domestic funds over a year or two. Global big names such as Morgan Stanley, Lehman Brothers, HSBC and ABN Amro are among those queuing up to pick up stake in local realty firms.

Banking Bill to be considered this session

The monsoon session of Parliament will see nine Bills including the Banking Companies (Acquisition and Transfer of Undertakings) and Financial Institutions Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2006 being taken up for discussion and passage.

China clings to austerity despite sharper economic dip

Bloomberg News

China's public spending plunged last month by the most since October, suggesting the government tightened fiscal policy further despite increasing calls for more support as economic growth slips.

A broad measure of expenditure tumbled 11.9 per cent in June from a year earlier, according to Bloomberg calculations based on Ministry of Finance data released Wednesday. By contrast, broad fiscal revenue gained 1.8 per cent.

That took the broad deficit in the first half to 4.57 trillion yuan (\$675 billion), 13 per cent less than a year earlier. Goldman Sachs Group Inc. estimates the "negative fiscal impulse" in April-June contributed more than 40

per cent of the sequential decline in real economic growth from the first to second quarter.

China's fiscal pullback has put a drag on overall investment, with economic expansion weakening more than expected in the second quarter. A shift toward looser policy is still likely as top officials call for faster deployment of pro-growth measures that have already been approved to ensure the economy expands enough to meet Beijing's annual target of 4.5-5 per cent.

The slowdown in fiscal expenditure "appears to be an intentional fine-tuning of the spending pace after strong first-quarter growth," Standard Chartered Plc. economists including Ding Shuang wrote in a Wednesday note.

"The government retains sizeable fiscal headroom within the budget



CHINA. Economic challenges REUTERS

framework approved in March," they said.

The Ministry of Finance said it will continue to carry out what it called a "more active" fiscal policy, according to a statement made in a video clip released as part of its quarterly briefing.

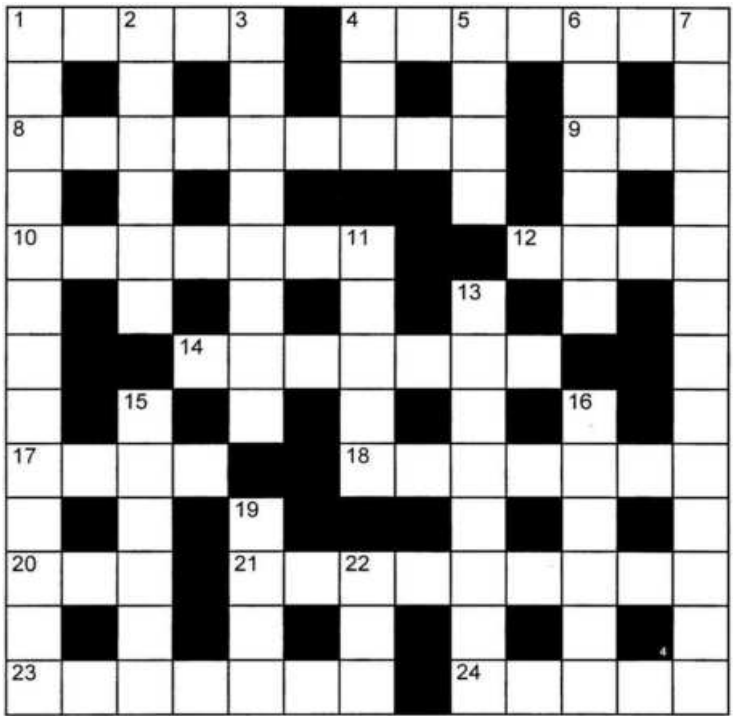
Among other steps, it said officials will "push for all existing policies to be rolled out on the ground and look to

"reasonably accelerate the pace of spending," along with stronger expenditure aimed at improving people's wellbeing.

The ministry also pledged continued backing for "the expansion of effective investment." That phrase hints at the government's continued focus on quality projects to avoid wasteful investment — an approach that's presented a hurdle for faster spending.

Infrastructure spending under the general public budget, the largest among the government's four books, fell almost 9 per cent in April-June from a year earlier, according to Bloomberg calculations based on the ministry's numbers. Meanwhile, the government's combined expenditure on education, healthcare as well as social security and employment rose 4.9 per cent in the period.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2700



EASY

ACROSS

- Was upright (5)
- By means of (7)
- Woke too late (9)
- State of equality (3)
- One posted to watch (7)
- Shoe, boot-stiffener (4)
- Lowered in rank (7)
- One-sided inclination (4)
- Enclosed field for horses (7)
- The lot (3)
- Do decorative needlework (9)
- Earnestly ask (7)
- Mannequin (5)

DOWN

- Scapula (8,5)
- King of the fairies (6)
- Find out; make known (8)
- Golf peg (3)
- Pity, sorrow (4)
- Game official (6)
- The scad, or tunny (5,8)
- A body of soldiers (5)
- Space above one in car, etc (8)
- Pocket-book (6)
- Squalid (6)
- Yield, give way (4)
- Noctule (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Was on one's feet looking for a seat (5)
- Is done with being nothing less than assiduous (7)
- Was lying too long to spot lever being moved (9)
- Equal value is not given in French capital (3)
- This is the prospect for one keeping watch (7)
- A branched stand peer tries to hold back (4)
- Is taken down a grade to meet odd variation (7)
- There's prejudice about a direction to play it twice (4)
- Odd to be back in the deck where horses are paraded (7)
- The whole lot is the same either side on court (3)
- How to add fictitious detail with a crewel needle perhaps (9)
- Beg one to enter the Terriers like this (7)
- How to make figure in clay an exemplar (5)

DOWN

- The scapula ought to be shown by real deb, maybe (8,5)
- No robe could be found for Titania's consort (6)
- Find out what one will turn to play the flip side (8)
- Where to drive off (leaving the hardbake) (3)
- The sorrow of a female character in the OT (4)
- Man in a white coat taking out endless premium (6)
- Fish a nag might expect to catch with a sprat (5,8)
- There may be space in the car for one's hat, too (8)
- Everything in the rain one can put one's money in (6)
- Mean odds, Rhode Island laid out (6)
- Give way to force, determined to take part (4)
- Flutter an eyelid at man who's in (3)

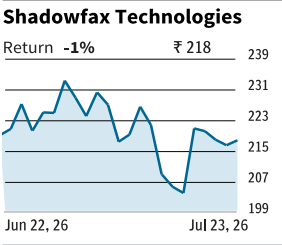
SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2699

ACROSS 2. Wager 5. Film 7. Smut 8. Instruct 9. Coverlet 11. Body 12. Chronological 15. Clay 17. Crockery 19. Homeward 21. Boom 22. Seam 23. Derby

DOWN 1. Mammoth 2. Wit 3. Grill 4. Risotto 5. Fir 6. Lucid 10. Ebony 11. Brisk 13. Orchard 14. Airport 16. Loose 18. Order 20. Elm 21. Bay

QUICKLY.

Eight Roads, Flipkart to sell stake in Shadowfax



Mumbai: Shadowfax Technologies is set to witness a block deal worth up to ₹1,047.5 crore (about \$108 million) on Friday, with existing investors Eight Roads Investments Mauritius II, Flipkart Internet and IMM India Fund looking to sell shares through a secondary market transaction. The deal involves up to 9.08 per cent of the company's total outstanding shares, with a floor price of ₹197 per share, representing a 9.9 per cent discount to the July 23 closing price of ₹218.58. The transaction is being managed by Kotak Securities and Morgan Stanley India. The sale is entirely secondary in nature, with proceeds accruing to the selling shareholders rather than the company. OUR BUREAU

Aastha Spintex board clears 1:1 bonus issue

Mumbai: The board of Aastha Spintex, an integrated cotton yarn manufacturer, has approved a 1:1 bonus issue of shares. The approval will increase the company's authorised share capital from ₹45 crore to ₹100 crore to facilitate the bonus issue. The board also recommended a final dividend of ₹0.1 per equity share of face value ₹10 for FY26. Divyang Jashwant Patel, Managing Director, Aastha Spintex, said the board's approval of the bonus issue and the increase in authorised share capital reflect the company's confidence in future growth and its commitment to create long-term value for shareholders. OUR BUREAU

Milky Mist Dairy IPO likely by mid-Aug

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Milky Mist Dairy Food Ltd, a value-added dairy company, is expected to launch its initial public offering (IPO) by mid-August, according to sources in the know, in what is set to be largest IPO by an Indian dairy company. The issue size was earlier proposed to be ₹2,035 crore, comprising the IPO and the pre-IPO placement. However, with the company having already raised ₹482 crore in a pre-IPO placement, the size of the issue now reflects the balance amount of ₹1,553 crore, sources said. Milky Mist declined to comment on the exact timeline of the IPO. The company obtained approval from SEBI for its ₹2,035 crore IPO in October 2025, and it has been one of

Axis Mutual acquires PMS biz of Axis Securities

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Axis Asset Management Company has acquired the Portfolio Management Services (PMS) business of Axis Securities, significantly augmenting its alternates platform and strengthening its presence in the rapidly growing high networth investor segment. The acquired business will operate under 'Alternates by Axis AMC'. The acquisition brings over 2,500 investors onto the Axis AMC platform, making it one of the largest PMS acquisitions in the country by investor count. With the addition, Axis AMC's PMS assets under management will increase to about ₹15,000 crore. The entire PMS team of Axis Securities, including investment professionals, product specialists, sales and client servicing teams will join Axis AMC. Axis AMC has appointed Naeen Kulkarni as CIO – PMS & Listed Equity Alternates.

The IPO engine is revving up again

BID & ASK. With validity of SEBI's approval ending in Sept, firms rush to launch IPOs amid global uncertainty

Suresh P Iyengar

Mumbai

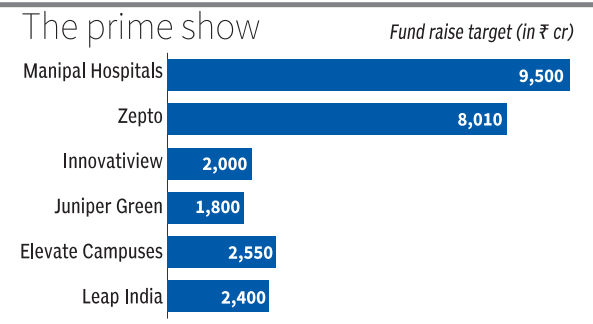
The primary market has been showing early signs of revival with the successful fundraising of ₹9,800 crore by SBI Funds Management and a rush of mid-sized IPOs to hit the market before September. However, global uncertainty remains a key factor to be watched. SEBI in April extended the one-year validity of IPO observation letters, expiring between April 1 and September 30, to September-end. In all, at least 14 companies are waiting in the wings to raise ₹28,033 crore in the next two months, with the largest being Manipal Hospitals and Zepto together eyeing ₹17,510 crore. In fact, ahead of the September deadline, eight companies

Online dispute resolution may get a leg up

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI on Thursday proposed a major overhaul of the online dispute resolution (ODR) framework for the securities market, shifting key responsibilities from ODR institutions to market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), such as stock exchanges, depositories and clearing corporations. The regulator said the proposed changes were aimed at addressing delays in arbitration, appointment of arbitrators, enforceability of awards and operational issues under the existing framework. "The issues raised include the process of appointment of arbitrators,

plan to raise less than ₹500 crore each. Payal Pandya, Vice-President, Bajaj Broking Research, said there was a sharp rebound in the primary market in July with healthy demand underscoring improving risk appetite despite lingering macroeconomic uncertainties. The primary market movement will be dictated by a better earnings season, geopolitical tensions and the potential impact of US tariff measures, she added. Tanvi Kanchan, Associate Director, Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers, said the sustained mutual fund inflows had created a deep reservoir of capital that supported new issues regardless of global volatility. The pipeline of high-quality, large-format issues like Reliance Jio and NSE may draw retail back, but smaller and mid-sized IPOs will struggle to find that support in a risk-



off environment, she said. Rajesh Singla, CEO Alpha AMC, said companies and bankers were recalibrating their approach by trimming issue sizes, conservative pricing and lowering 'offer for sale' component in favour of larger fresh issue portions. A pipeline of 143 companies holding active SEBI approvals gives enough raw material for a busy second half, but whether it will translate into a genuine revival depends on secondary

market stability holding and FII appetite returning to large-cap issuances, he said. Nandish Shah, AVP-PCG Research & Advisory, Wealth Management, Motilal Oswal Financial Services, said the September deadline requiring SEBI-approved IPO companies to either launch their offerings or refresh financial disclosures has accelerated filing timelines, compelling companies to move forward with their public offerings. Akshay Gupta, Director,

SEBI proposes major PMS overhaul, opens door to overseas and pre-IPO investments

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI on Thursday proposed a comprehensive overhaul of the Portfolio Managers Regulations, seeking to widen investment opportunities, simplify compliance and introduce a new mutual fund-only portfolio management service (MF-PMS) framework aimed at making professionally managed investments more accessible. The proposals come after a review of the sector, which has seen assets under management more than double to ₹42.61 lakh crore as of May 2026 from ₹18.07 lakh

Prime Securities, said the liquidity conditions had improved sentiments with falling government bond yields and a stable rupee, besides strong international and domestic capital flows. However, rising crude and diesel costs from the West Asia/Europe conflicts along with oil marketing companies already reporting over ₹1.8 lakh crore in under-recoveries in Q1FY27 could be a potential drag on sentiment. Shrey Jain, CEO, Stocko by InCred Money, said nearly 250 companies were waiting to raise over ₹4 lakh crore via IPO though issuances have been slow so far, given geopolitical factors and macroeconomic conditions. Any move of supply significantly exceeding demand in the primary market could lead to weakness and depress valuations or push some IPOs further down the pipeline, he said.

Crude surge, Iran tensions lead markets to 4th day of losses

Anupama Ghosh

Mumbai

The markets extended their losing streak for a fourth consecutive session on Thursday as a sharp spike in crude oil prices, escalating US-Iran tensions, and relentless foreign selling kept investors firmly on the back foot. The Nifty 50 slipped below the psychologically significant 24,000 mark, a threshold that traders had been watching closely and settled at 23,869, down 0.53 per cent on the day. The Sensex fell in tandem, closing at 76,391, off 0.47 per cent. "Crude oil prices approaching USD 100/bbl amid concerns over further disruptions to global energy supplies... investor sentiment remained subdued as markets reassessed inflation risks and corporate margins," said Ponmudi R, CEO, Enrich Money. The session opened with a

gap-down and a brief, unconvincing recovery attempt before sustained selling through the afternoon pushed the index lower. Broad-based weakness defined the day. Realty stocks were the worst performers, falling nearly 1.8 per cent, while chemicals, PSU banks and oil and gas stocks were also among the key laggards. State-owned OMCs, HPCL and BPCL, faced added heat after reporting under-recoveries in the Q1 of FY27 as higher input costs could not be fully passed on to consumers. The mid and small-cap segments fared worse than the headline index, with both the Nifty Midcap 100 and the Nifty Smallcap 100 declining around 1 per cent each, reflecting widespread selling. Of the Nifty 500 universe, 383 settled in the red. Auto and media were the sole sectoral exceptions, posting gains on the back of resilient earnings.

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Milky Mist Dairy Food Ltd, a value-added dairy company, is expected to launch its initial public offering (IPO) by mid-August, according to sources in the know, in what is set to be largest IPO by an Indian dairy company. The issue size was earlier proposed to be ₹2,035 crore, comprising the IPO and the pre-IPO placement. However, with the company having already raised ₹482 crore in a pre-IPO placement, the size of the issue now reflects the balance amount of ₹1,553 crore, sources said. Milky Mist declined to comment on the exact timeline of the IPO. The company obtained approval from SEBI for its ₹2,035 crore IPO in October 2025, and it has been one of



the most anticipated listings. **PRE-IPO BOOST** The company's public market debut follows a ₹482-crore pre-IPO fundraising completed in May, led by Jongsong Investments Pte Ltd, an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Temasek Holdings. Based on the pre-IPO investment price of ₹139.76 a share, Milky Mist was valued at approximately ₹9,300 crore. Founded in Erode, Milky Mist focuses entirely on value-added dairy products. Its portfolio includes paneer, cheese, curd, yogurt, butter,

ghee, ice cream and other dairy-based products. Milky Mist does not operate in the milk segment. The issue comprises a fresh issue and an offer for sale (OFS) by the existing promoters Sathishkumar and Anitha Sathish. According to the Draft Red Herring Prospectus, the proceeds from the fresh issue will be utilised towards repayment of borrowings and the expansion and modernisation of its manufacturing facility at Perundurai. The expansion is said to be around manufacturing of newer categories such as whey protein concentrate, yogurt and cream cheese plants. JM Financial Ltd, Axis Capital and IIFL Capital Services Ltd are the book-running lead managers to the issue. Other listed peers in the sector include Parag Milk Foods, Hatsun Agro Product and Doodla Dairy.

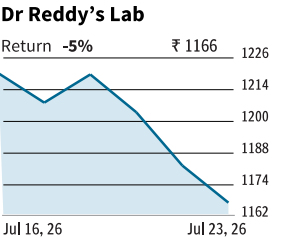
Dr Reddy's Lab hits a year's low on weak Q1 results

Our Bureau

Bengaluru

Shares of Dr Reddy's Laboratories declined on Thursday as it reported a 69 per cent y-o-y decline in net profit to ₹443 crore for the quarter ended June 30, 2026. The stock closed at ₹1,166.30, down 1.39 per cent, hitting a fresh 52-week low of ₹1,101 on the NSE. The stock reaction followed a weak quarter marked by pressure on margins, gSema-related issues and higher solvent, freight and SG&A costs.

BEARISH ANALYSTS CLSA said Dr Reddy's reported in-line revenue, but margins were below its estimate due to gSema issues and higher solvent and freight costs, with the latter driven by the West Asia conflict. It expects gSema issues to stabilise in November 2026. It retained a 'Hold' rating with a target price of ₹1,240. JP Morgan retained its 'Underweight' with a target price of ₹1,100. It attributed the margin pressure to



higher SG&A and freight costs' and said weak core profitability persists despite the branded business contributing 52 per cent of revenues. Jefferies retained its 'Underperform' call with a target price of ₹1,040, saying the first quarter missed estimates materially even after adjusting for a one-off provision. Citi retained its 'Sell' with a target price of ₹1,040, and BofA maintained its 'Accumulate' with a target price of ₹1,480, compared with an earlier target of ₹1,500. Morgan Stanley retained its 'Equal-weight' with a target price of ₹1,200 versus ₹1,215 earlier. It said timely resumption of semaglutide supplies and Abatacept ramp-up are key to meeting the FY28 estimates.

BROKER'S CALL.

Anand Rathi Research

HINDUSTAN AERONAUTICS (BUY)
Target: ₹5,431
CMP: ₹4,592.05
After more than two years of delays, Hindustan Aeronautics' (HAL's) Tejas Mk-1A programme seems to be moving closer to delivery. As per our check, air-to-air and air-to-ground weapon trials (including Astra, ASRAAM missiles and laser-guided bombs) have been completed, while pending software patches are awaiting certification. HAL's Tejas Mk1A programme is seeing a marked improvement in engine. While it has received seven GE F404-IN20 engines so far, it should get a batch of 10 engines from GE before November 2026. Further, HAL has manufactured first 20 Tejas Mk-1A (another eight-nine are at different stages of fabrication) and flight-tested, parked pending engine fitment. It aims to deliver first squadron of 16-18 aircraft by March 2027. HAL's order-book remains strong at ₹2.45 lakh crore, led by large wins in FY26 including 97 LCA Tejas, six ALH and eight Dornier Do-228 orders. The management expects about ₹90,000-crore order inflow over FY27/28e (including ROH), which offers multi-year visibility. The management has guided for 10-12 per cent revenue growth in FY27 and sees EBITDA margin at 30-31 per cent. We expect near-term re-rating to be driven by Mk-1A deliveries, GE engine supply discipline. We retain BUY rating on HAL with a DCF-based TP of ₹5,431. **Key Risks:** (a) Undue delay in engine supply; (b) execution slippages in Mk-1A; (c) WC intensity, and (d) deferral of large defence contracts.

Systematix

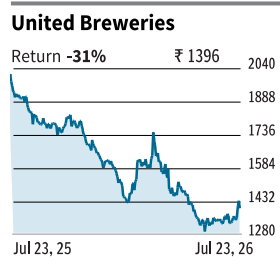
R SYSTEMS (BUY)
Target: ₹300
CMP: ₹248.80
R Systems (RSYS) has evolved its business model to accelerate revenue growth over CY26-28E, supported by completed leadership reinforcement, sales incentives aligned to quality deal wins, disciplined account farming, healthy ACM momentum, a strengthened partner ecosystem, geographic expansion and AI-led offerings. RSYS' EBIT margin expanded 640 bps to 15.3 per cent over Q1CY24-Q1CY26, driven by operating leverage, operating efficiency, acquisition-led accretion and currency tailwinds. However, margins are expected to remain under pressure through the remaining quarters of CY26 due to wage revisions, lower utilisation, AI investments and higher subcontractor expenses. We estimate EBIT margin at 14.7 per cent in CY26, stabilising at 14.8 per cent in CY27-28. The Novigo acquisition comprises an upfront cash consideration of ₹400 crore, with additional stock-based earn-out linked to future EBITDA achievement. While AI is disrupting the traditional product engineering model by reducing billable hours and compressing SDLC, RSYS has delivered organic revenue growth over the last few years. The company has built proprietary AI studios for SDLC acceleration, and agentic AI workflows, positioning AI as a TAM expander. We raised our target P/E multiple to 13x (from 12x), driven by strong account mining, a healthy cash balance and potential growth pick-up. Accordingly, we maintain our Buy rating with a revised target price of ₹300, based on 13x September 2028E EPS.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

United Breweries (₹1,396.15): BUY

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl_research_bureau



The stock of United Breweries has been in a downtrend since April 2025 with intermittent corrective rallies in July 2025 and February 2026. Likewise, the scrip has been in a sideways correction since early June. That is, it was oscillating between ₹1,310 and ₹1,370 until early this week. On Tuesday, the stock broke out of ₹1,370, opening the door for further rally. The price is now above both the 21- and 50-day moving averages, supporting the positive bias. Although there was a price correction on Wednesday, the near-term

outlook has turned positive. Buy now at ₹1,396 and ₹1,370. Place stop-loss at ₹1,300. When the stock rises to ₹1,450 and ₹1,500, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,400 and ₹1,470 respectively. Book profits at ₹1,525.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23886 » Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
23800	23570	24000	24300	Short the contract if it slips below 23800; stop-loss can be 24000.	
₹748 » HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
742	730	755	770	Stock might decline; go short at 755 and place stop-loss at 770.	
₹1052 » Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1040	1000	1060	1080	Stock is facing a resistance; go short with a stop-loss at 1070.	
₹281 » ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
278	275	284	290	Stock is oscillating within a range; refrain from new positions.	
₹252 » ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
250	246	256	260	The outlook is positive; go long now and place a stop-loss at 246.	
₹1275 » Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1270	1255	1280	1292	Sell the stock if it slips below 1270; place a stop-loss at 1292.	
₹1012 » SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1008	985	1020	1040	Initiate short if the price rises to 1020; stop-loss can be at 1040.	
₹2242 » TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2200	2155	2280	2300	Buy the stock if the price dips to 2225; keep a stop-loss at 2190.	
S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.					

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 126.65 pts.
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
M&M	3229.70	10.61	21.57	2.64	
TCS	2242.90	7.72	16.21	2.10	
Bajaj Auto	11283.50	6.89	27.30	1.14	
SBI Life	1883.50	4.59	75.27	0.76	
Eternal Ltd	287.10	4.26	757.00	1.90	
Kotak Bank	383.35	3.54	18.79	2.58	
Eicher Motors	7721.50	2.69	38.43	0.97	
Sun Pharma	1954.00	2.54	40.74	1.89	
TataConsumerProduct	1107.70	1.82	70.87	0.66	
Hindalco	955.55	1.79	16.12	1.27	
HCL Tech	1244.70	1.70	19.37	1.20	
Bajaj Finserv	1889.40	1.64	15.37	1.00	
Hind Unilever	2161.80	1.40	48.00	1.75	
ITC	281.30	1.05	16.77	2.48	
Max Healthcare	1084.20	0.52	73.15	0.74	
PowerGrid Corp	289.80	0.49	16.92	1.20	
ONGC	252.37	0.40	6.38	0.90	
UltraTech Cement	11908.00	0.39	40.94	1.29	
Wipro	174.82	0.24	13.82	0.46	
HDFC Life	550.95	-0.51	60.19	0.54	
Tech Mahindra	1555.80	-0.67	29.53	0.90	
Coal India	427.05	-0.71	8.47	0.94	
Trent Ltd.	2974.60	-0.91	39.89	0.88	
Bharat Elec	405.35	-1.10	48.88	1.33	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	233.16	-1.18	74.50	0.70	
Titan	4697.30	-1.29	82.19	1.77	
Tata Motors PV	324.30	-1.55	3981.14	0.62	
Apollo Hosp	8862.00	-1.71	63.63	0.83	
NTPC	148.60	-1.97	12.27	1.51	
Dr Reddys Lab	1116.37	-2.20	23.41	0.65	
Asian Paints	2668.80	-2.37	58.25	1.10	
Cipla	1393.00	-2.72	29.14	0.72	
Infosys	1047.40	-3.60	14.42	3.36	
Maruti Suzuki	13403.00	-4.05	28.71	1.60	
JSh Steel	1246.80	-4.12	10.89	1.07	
Tata Steel	184.23	-4.15	21.13	1.39	
Grasim Ind	3113.00	-4.39	20.57	1.07	
Int'lGlobeavi	5023.50	-4.62	0.00	1.04	
L&T	3792.40	-6.39	27.53	4.06	
Adani Ports	1778.50	-6.59	32.06	1.20	
NestleIndia	1447.90	-7.16	79.79	0.95	
Adani Enter	5311.5	-8.68	38.35	0.79	
ICI Bank	1434.60	-9.54	17.22	9.40	
Axis Bank	3233.00	-9.66	13.62	3.21	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1025.80	-10.09	24.08	1.31	
State Bank	1012.60	-11.19	10.79	3.83	
Bharti Airtel	1931.00	-11.95	34.79	5.37	
Bajaj Finance	1039.80	-12.00	33.49	2.55	
HDFC Bank	147.25	-19.73	13.95	19.47	
Reliance Ind	1272.20	-24.20	19.53	7.86	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 456.20 pts.

	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Bajaj Holdings	10636.00	26.55	12.09	1.86
Samvardhanatothersinternat	145.57	25.29	37.61	2.60
Bosch	42240.00	17.14	44.92	1.48
Avenueuper	4035.90	16.16	86.08	2.63
Tata Motors Cv	407.90	14.87	49.61	3.45
Torrent Pharma	5065.20	13.56	90.11	3.01
United Spirits	1418.00	11.85	55.24	1.69
Vedanta	264.60	11.33	6.52	1.82
Hindustanaeronautics	4592.50	9.76	33.69	3.52
Siemens	3686.30	9.48	85.65	1.32
Tvs Motor Cmp	3919.80	8.33	51.71	3.72
Cummins India	5599.00	5.10	65.72	3.06
Shree Cement	26825.00	4.08	55.35	1.45
Hyundai Motor India	1954.40	3.65	29.24	1.13
Abb India	7528.00	3.36	100.96	1.60
Varun Beverages	459.05	3.18	48.38	2.54
Mazagon Dock	2298.90	-1.88	33.65	0.71
Indian Hotels Co.	724.05	-2.04	44.64	2.57
Indian Railway Finance Corp	87.03	-2.10	16.23	0.71
Jindal Steel	1041.90	-3.34	31.62	1.56
LtImidtree	3965.30	-4.62	22.63	1.49
Punjab Natl Bank	1101.5	-5.80	5.72	1.53
Hindus Zinc	5311.5	-5.94	16.23	1.03
Muthootfin	3010.40	-7.85	11.39	1.31
Rural Elec	358.45	-7.99	5.79	1.81
Gail (India)	17.79	-8.00	14.92	1.88
Tata Capital	341.45	-8.63	29.63	0.70
Zydusfinesciences	1113.80	-9.09	21.87	1.13
Power Finance	410.05	-9.52	4.02	2.42
Tata Power	376.15	-11.63	23.49	2.54
Maxima Developers .	117.73	-11.77	33.38	1.29
Godrej Consumer	1056.60	-11.91	58.17	1.29
Siemens Energy India	3328.80	-11.98	90.44	1.19
Canara Bank	125.22	-12.11	6.35	1.70
United Bank	168.40	-12.58	6.23	1.32
Amul& Co	423.55	-13.14	19.15	1.07
Chaudharamini&Fin	117.13	-13.45	27.98	1.58
Bank of Baroda	243.15	-14.02	6.27	1.82
Solar Industries	18621.00	-16.64	97.03	1.83
Dif	642.20	-17.34	36.01	1.67
Hdfc Aac	2508.70	-22.10	36.48	0.27
Indian Oilcorp	139.92	-22.91	4.52	2.11
Power Grids	390.85	-24.44	5.20	2.54
Divs Lab	7305.00	-30.10	75.52	3.76
Britannia Ind	3338.00	-33.58	51.15	2.57
Adani Energy Solutions .	1663.80	-38.75	65.45	2.24
Pidilint	154.20	-39.98	64.43	1.96
Adani Power.	2112.23	-66.92	31.55	3.56
Adani Green & Sol	104.00	-67.89	116.31	2.45
AdaniGreenenergy	1379.90	-96.02	114.39	1.87

Pts: Impact on index movement

Mumbai: The National Company Law Tribunal has stayed the insolvency bidding process of Byju's parent company Think & Learn till the next hearing on August 31, providing temporary relief to the company's founders. The Bengaluru bench of the NCLT directed the resolution professional not to proceed with the issuance of Form G or to finalise the list of prospective resolution applicants until further orders. OUR BUREAU

Modi vows fast-track courts to punish exam leak culprits

SUPPORTIVE STANCE. Govt reaching out to protestors, Opposition to diffuse crisis

Our Bureau
New Delhi

With Prime Minister Narendra Modi vowing on Thursday to set up fast-track courts for “swift and stringent punishment” to those involved in exam leaks which pushed agitated students to participate in the Jantar Mantar protest, the government intensified attempts to diffuse the crisis by repeatedly reaching out to the Opposition as well as the protestors for having discussions in Parliament and outside with the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) functionaries, respectively.

“Nothing is more important than the welfare and future of our youth!” the Prime Minister posted on X early on Thursday. “We have decided to set up fast-track courts to ensure swift and stringent punishment for those involved in paper leaks. I have directed the concerned authorities and officials to take all necessary steps in this regard,” he said in his direct outreach to youth, two days after he reacted for the first time on the issue, calling it a “grave sin” at the NDA parliamentary party meeting.

Modi also stated in the social media post that this is part of a series of steps the government had taken to hold paper leak culprits accountable. “This continues our series of steps for safe-



STRICT ACTION. PM Modi said that the government had taken a series of steps to hold paper leak culprits accountable

guarding the interests of students. Those who try to harm the future of our youth will not be spared,” he promised.

Protestors and the CJP functionaries rejected Modi’s proposal, sticking to their demand for the resignation of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, saying that the court trial could follow.

As a response to the PM, CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke shared an image of Pradhan bearing the caption, “Hi, my name is nothing”. The CJP reiterated, “Dharmendra Pradhan must resign” while its national spokesperson Ashutosh Ranka welcomed Modi’s response but said it came after nearly one-and-a-half months of protests and did not answer the central question behind the repeated paper leaks.

CONCERNS RAISED

Veteran BJP leader Murlu Manohar Joshi came out in support of the protesting students, with a post on X. Seconding their “anxieties

and concerns” regarding the examination system as “genuine”, Joshi criticised the police crackdown against the protesting students, especially girls, calling it “merciless”.

GENUINE WORRIES

“It is painful to see young students from different parts of the country assembled for days on the streets of New Delhi. Their anxieties and concerns regarding the examination system are genuine and must be handled with empathy and a desire to find a lasting solution,” Joshi said in his post.

Trouble-shooters from the government, Union Ministers JP Nadda, Kiren Rijju and Jitendra Singh, were busy at work to break the stalemate between the ruling dispensation and the combined front of protestors and the Opposition.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Rijuji said the government is hopeful of finding a resolution through discussions with the Congress and

other Opposition colleagues, especially since the Prime Minister had made it abundantly clear on Thursday that steps were being taken to safeguard the lives and security of the students and the youth.

Speaking to reporters, Rijju reiterated his earlier charge that he had reached out to Opposition members across party lines to facilitate a structured debate. But the Opposition began offering “excuses” to stall proceedings.

Parallely, Union Minister Jitendra Singh said the Central government had reiterated its commitment to dialogue, stating that it had extended multiple formal invitations to student representatives for discussions.

“I would like to appeal to the students and young friends participating in this protest to come forward for a dialogue. Our doors are open,” he said, making a “humble appeal” on behalf of the government.

TALKS LINED UP

He said the discussion with the protesting students’ representatives will be held under the leadership of Union Health Minister and senior BJP leader J P Nadda.

Parliament proceedings remained stalled for the fourth day on Thursday with the Opposition unwilling to budge on its demand for the sacking of Pradhan from the Union Cabinet.

The ‘meme-first’ approach of Gen Z activism

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The ongoing youth movement led by the Cockroach Janta Party’s ‘meme-first’ approach, leveraging visual platforms such as Instagram, is playing a key role in gaining traction among Gen Z.

Followers of the movement have been sharing their experiences and opinions often through reels and short videos posted especially on platforms such as Instagram.

After posting its first Instagram post on May 17, CJP garnered nearly 3 million followers within the first 78 hours.

As of Thursday, its follower account had swelled to as much as 25.6 million followers on the platform, garnering strong engagement and views.

Founded by Abhijeet Dipke as a satirical joke, post the remarks made by the Chief Justice of India, CPJ’s Instagram account has more followers than BJP and the Congress on the platform.

KEY ROLE

Observers and experts believe this radical, different approach, compared with traditional political campaigns, is playing a key role in the movement, resonating with Gen Z.

It perhaps also indicates that as Gen Z comes of age, political discourse is expected to play out even more on visual storytelling-led platforms such as Instagram.

“The current movement owes its origins to digital natives who have played off the CJI’s remark to create an identity for themselves



UP IN ARMS. CJP activists continued their protest, seeking the resignation of Union Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi on Thursday SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

through the Cockroach Janta Party. This is radically different from traditional political campaigns or even the IAC movement in 2011. Using the cockroach meme, they

have been able to reach out to young audiences who saw the irony and self-deprecating humour and joined the bandwagon. A bit similar to what was seen in the US with

the take-off of the term ‘deplorables’ in 2016 US Presidential Election,” said business strategist Lloyd Mathias. “As digital natives, they have mastered the ‘meme-first’ politics with their followers sharing visuals, banners, memes, reels and comments laced with humour and satire, which resonate well on platforms like Instagram. This is very unlike traditional political parties which are all about staid speeches, slogans and amplifying leaders’ voices,” he added.

Mathias pointed out that it is an “internet-first movement”.

“Activism has usually been seen as a serious business. Gen Z is resonating with the irony, sarcasm and visual storytelling approach. This is more of an internet-first movement,” he noted.

Internet suspended, heavy security cover in central Delhi

Our Bureau
New Delhi

A heavy security blanket descended over central Delhi on Thursday as the authorities stepped up measures to contain the fallout of the protests by Cockroach Janta Party, with large contingents of the Delhi Police and the Rapid Action Force (RAF) deployed across key locations, internet services suspended around the protest site, and major commercial establishments asked to shut early.

Internet services were suspended in Jantar Mantar, where protesters have been demonstrating, with the restrictions extending to Sansad Marg and parts of central Delhi. Protesters alleged that mobile

networks became inaccessible on entering the protest sites, making communication difficult. The shutdown follows the suspension of Internet services on Wednesday night after clashes were reported between the police and protesters at Sansad Marg.

The heightened security was accompanied by unprecedented precautionary measures across the city centre.

‘CRITICAL SITUATION’

New Delhi Traders Association (NDTA), citing directions conveyed by the NDMC Chairman and Vice-Chairman, issued an advisory asking all shops, offices and restaurants in Connaught Place to close by 6.30 pm on Thursday in view of the “critical situation” in the area.

The advisory urged the establishments to comply to avoid “any unpleasant situation” and prevent loss of property or injury.

The restrictions came even as access to central Delhi remained severely disrupted.

Seventeen Delhi Metro stations continued to remain closed for the second consecutive day, affecting thousands of commuters and forcing diversions across the city.

With security forces maintaining a strong presence around Parliament Street, Jantar Mantar and adjoining areas, the national capital witnessed one of its most extensive security deployments in recent months as authorities sought to prevent any escalation of the protests.

Kerala to set up ‘watchtower’ to identify overseas jobs for youth

Chitra Narayanan
V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Riding on the artificial intelligence (AI) wave, Kerala is set to establish a global ‘watchtower’ to identify emerging job opportunities for the State’s youth across different countries and industries, Chief Minister VD Satheesan has said.

“We have begun appointing experts from various sectors to monitor developments in the global jobs market. They will submit periodic reports to the government and based on their findings, we will restructure the curriculum and introduce new academic programmes that align with future employment opportunities,” he said while inaugurating the office of Naviq Technology, a new AI company, at the IBS Software Campus in Infopark, Kochi, on Thursday.

GOVERNMENT’S VISION

He declared that the government’s vision is to transform Kerala into a hub for AI and other emerging technologies.



Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan

Highlighting the role of AI in governance, he said AI should be adopted as a powerful tool to improve government services. As a first step, an AI-powered dashboard will be introduced in the Chief Minister’s Office, and a nodal officer will be appointed to oversee its implementation and ensure its smooth functioning.

EARLY WARNINGS

The government has already begun using AI to help prevent human-wildlife conflict. Experts are developing AI-based mechanisms to detect the presence of wild animals near human settlements. The system will issue early warnings and attempt to

drive the animals away using lights, followed by sound-based deterrents if necessary.

GLOBAL TRENDS

Referring to global trends, he said farmers around the world are increasingly using AI for weather forecasting, selecting suitable seeds, soil testing, and improving agricultural productivity. Kerala, too, is leveraging AI for disaster management, climate protection, and other public service initiatives.

He also stressed that keeping knowledge up to date has become one of the biggest challenges of the modern era.

Future technologies such as AI, quantum computing, biotechnology, genetic engineering, and renewable energy are rapidly reshaping industries. “There is a need to embrace these technologies for the benefit of the youth,” he said.

Kerala IT Secretary Seeram Sambasiva Rao said the State government is in the process of setting up a dedicated organisation, Future Corporation, to focus on investment promotion in the technology sector.

‘PM Surya Ghar to surpass 50 lakh households soon’

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Emphasising India’s strong track record of delivery in the renewables space, Minister for New & Renewable Energy Pralhad Joshi said on Thursday that households under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana (PMSG: MBY) are expected to surpass 50 lakh in the next few weeks.

In his address during a curtain raiser event for the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo 2026, Joshi emphasised that India’s credibility on the global stage is built on its strong track record of delivery, which has enabled it to convene the global renewable energy community.

India will soon cross the landmark of 300 gigawatt of installed non-fossil fuel capacity. He also informed that the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana is expected to cross 50 lakh beneficiary households in the coming weeks.

Launched in February 2024 with an outlay of ₹75,021 crore, PMSG: MBY has become the world’s largest domestic rooftop solar programme.

the data to give a lot of predictive tools to help our customers do their business better,” he said.

IBS Software has clients such as Emirates, British Airways, and Heathrow Airport, among others.

Speaking at the launch, Kunhalikutty said every technological change brings new job opportunities. “It is a reality that tech will keep changing very fast, and it is up to us to keep changing,” he said, describing how Kerala was rewriting its IT Mission in view of this. It was also updating its future technology mission.

Mathew pointed out that India’s IT services revenue, which commands 20 per cent of the world tech services market, had been declining year on year, while AI revenue, still at a very small base, is growing exponentially.

Naviq Technology, IBS Group’s new travel AI company takes flight in Kochi

Chitra Narayanan
V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

Thiruvananthapuram-based travel software giant IBS Group is betting big on artificial intelligence (AI) with a \$500 million investment in a new AI company called Naviq Technology, which was formally launched in Kochi by Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan and Industries and IT minister PK Kunhalikutty.

“Today, 25 per cent of the world’s economy is digital, and the era of AI has just begun. The future is going to be very different in the way we produce, distribute, and consume — much of it powered by AI. This is the context in which we are launching Naviq, a vertical AI company for the travel sector,” said VK Mathew, the founder of IBS



TECH LAUNCH. Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan inaugurating Naviq Technologies, IBS Software’s new AI venture, at the company’s Infopark campus in Kochi on Thursday RK NITHIN

Software, in his address.

He said the size of the sector that IBS served — the global travel sector — was nearly \$12 trillion or ₹100 lakh crore, and “we know the business is going to be dramatically changed with AI”.

GLOBAL TRAVEL

Naviq, with a swank office in Kochi’s Infopark within the IBS Software campus, hit the

ground running with 2,000 employees onboard and plans to scale the staff count to 5,000 soon.

Running several airport, airline and cruise operations databases, Mathew said the company had a minute-by-minute picture of travel operations and how journeys begin long before take-off. “We don’t own the data but we will be able to make use of



ONGC
एन.ओ.एन.जी.सी.
MRPL

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise and a subsidiary of Oil and Natural Gas Corporation Limited)
Corporate Identification Number - L19200KA1988GOI008959
Regd. Office: Mudapadav, Kuthethoor P.O., Via Katipalla, Mangaluru - 575 030
E-Mail : investor@mrpl.co.in Website : www.mrpl.co.in



LIFE
Lifestyle for Environment

NOTICE TO THE SHAREHOLDERS FOR 38th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING (AGM)

NOTICE is hereby given that the Thirty Eighth (38th) Annual General Meeting ('AGM' or 'Meeting') of the Members of **Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited** (the 'Company') will be held on **Monday, August 24, 2026 at 04.00 p.m. (IST)** through Video Conference / Other Audio Visual Means ('OAVM') ONLY, to transact the business as set out in the Notice of the AGM.

The Ministry of Corporate Affairs, Government of India ('MCA') vide its circular No. 03/2025 dated 22nd September 2025, 9/2024 dated 19th September, 2024, read with circulars dated April 8, 2020, April 13, 2020, May 05, 2020, January 13, 2021, May 05, 2022, December 28, 2022 and September 19, 2024 (collectively referred to as 'MCA Circulars') and the Securities and Exchange Board of India ('SEBI') also vide its Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-2/P/CIR/2023/167 dated 7th October, 2023 and SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-2/P/CIR/2024/133 dated 3rd October, 2024 ('SEBI Circulars'), provided certain relaxations from compliance with certain provisions of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ('SEBI Listing Regulations') in connection with conduct of AGM. In compliance with these Circulars, provisions of the Act and SEBI Listing Regulations, the Notice of the 38th Annual General Meeting (AGM) along with the weblink for Annual Report for 2025-26 of the Company has been sent through electronic mode on **July 23, 2026** to those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company or Registrar & Transfer Agent ('Registrar') and Depositories. Pursuant to Regulation 36(1)(b) of SEBI Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements (LODR) Regulation 2015, a letter providing the web link of the Annual Report is being sent to those shareholder who have not registered their e-mail address. The Annual Report for 2025-26 of the Company, inter alia, containing the Notice and the Explanatory Statement of the 38th AGM is available on the website of the Company at **www.mrpl.co.in** and on the websites of the Stock Exchanges viz. **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**. A copy of the same is also available on the website of National Securities Depository Limited ('NSDL') at **www.evoting.nsdl.com**.

Remote e-Voting:

In compliance with Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 ('the Act') read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended from time to time, the Secretarial Standard on General Meetings (SS-2) issued by the Institute of Company Secretaries of India and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, the Company is providing to its Members the facility of remote e-Voting before / during the AGM in respect of the business to be transacted at the AGM and for this purpose, the Company has appointed NSDL for facilitating voting through electronic means. The detailed instructions for remote e-Voting are given in the Notice of the 38th AGM.

Members are requested to note the following:

- The remote e-Voting facility would be available from Friday, August 21, 2026 (9.00 a.m. IST) and shall conclude on Sunday, August 23, 2026 (5.00 p.m. IST).
- The remote e-Voting module shall be disabled by NSDL for voting thereafter and Members will not be allowed to vote electronically beyond the said date and time.
- The voting rights of the Members shall be in proportion to their share of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on **Monday, August 17, 2026** ('cut-off date'). The facility of remote e-Voting system shall also be made available during the Meeting and the Members attending the Meeting, who have not already cast their vote by remote e-Voting shall be able to exercise their right during the Meeting till 15 minutes of the conclusion of the AGM.
- A person whose name is recorded in the Register of Members / Register of Beneficial Owners as on the cut-off date only shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-Voting before / during the AGM. Members who have cast their vote by remote e-Voting prior to the Meeting may also attend the Meeting electronically, but shall not be entitled to vote again.
- Members holding shares in physical mode or whose e-mail addresses are not registered may cast their vote through e-voting system, after registering their email addresses by sending the following documents to the Company at **investor@mrpl.co.in** or to the Share Transfer Agent at **investor.helpdesk@in.mmps.mufig.com**
 - Scanned copy of signed request letter mentioning Folio No., Name of the Shareholder, scanned copy of the Share Certificate (front and back), PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar card) for registering email address along with self-attested copy of latest electricity bill, AADHAR/PASSPORT copy in support of latest address.
 - Members holding shares in demat form should contact their Depository Participant (DP) and registered email address in the demat account, as per the process advised by your DP.
- A non-individual shareholder or shareholder holding securities in physical mode, who acquires shares of the Company and becomes a Member of the Company after the transmission of the Notice and holds shares as on the cut-off date, may obtain the User ID and Password for e-Voting by sending a request at **evoting@nsdl.co.in**. However, if the Member is already registered with NSDL for remote e-Voting then he/she can use his/her existing User ID and password for casting the vote.
- Individual shareholder holding securities in electronic mode and who acquires shares of the Company and becomes a Member of the Company after transmission of the Notice and holds shares as of the cut-off date may follow the login process mentioned in the Notice of the AGM. Members can also login by using the existing login credentials of the demat account held through Depository Participant registered with NSDL or CDSL for e-voting facility.
- A person who is not a Member as on the cut-off date should treat the Notice of the AGM for information purposes only.
- M/s Kumar Naresh Sinha & Associates, Practicing Company Secretaries, Noida, has been appointed as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-Voting process before / during the AGM in a fair and transparent manner.
- If Members facing any technical issue in login before/during the AGM can contact NSDL helpdesk by sending a request at **evoting@nsdl.com** or call at 022-4886 7000.

Special Window for Re-lodgement of Transfer Requests of Physical Shares which were lodged prior to the deadline of April 01, 2019:

SEBI vide Circular HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MRSD-PoD/13750/2026 dated January 30, 2026 decided to open another a special window only for re-lodgement of transfer deeds, and SEBI vide Circular which were lodged prior to the deadline of April 01, 2019 and rejected/returned/not available due to deficiency in the documents/process/or otherwise, for a period of One Year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027. During this period, the securities that are re lodged for transfer (including those requests that are pending with the listed company / RTA, as on date) shall be issued only in demat mode. Due process shall be followed for such transfer-cum-demat requests.

Investors can contact the Company's Registrars and Transfer Agents, M/s MUFG Intime India Private Limited for assistance at the below address:

M/s. MUFG INTIME INDIA PRIVATE LIMITED
C-101, 247 Park, L.B.S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai- 400 083.
Tel.: 022-49186270 Fax No.: 022-49186060, E-mail: investor.helpdesk@in.mmps.mufig.com

For Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited
Sd/-
Premachandra Rao G
Company Secretary

Place: Mangaluru
Date: 23 July 2026

QUICKLY.

Copper dips as geopolitical tensions soar



London: Copper gave up early gains to trade lower, tracking equity markets downwards after oil prices hit their highest in more than seven weeks on escalating hostilities in West Asia. Benchmark three-month copper on the London Metal Exchange was down 0.6 per cent at \$13,725.50 a tonne at 0930 GMT. Thin inventories were supporting copper prices, however, with available LME stocks of 107,850 tonnes — the lowest since January. Aluminium fell 0.3 per cent to \$3,183, zinc rose 0.6 per cent to \$3,614 and nickel gained one per cent to \$17,405, while tin added 0.6 per cent to \$54,020 and lead edged up by 0.2 per cent to \$1,899.50. REUTERS

Gold falls as US-Iran crisis fuels inflation fears



Gold fell more than two per cent on Thursday, retreating from a two-week high hit in the previous session as the West Asia conflict drove energy prices higher, fuelling inflation concerns and reinforcing expectations of US interest rate hikes this year. Spot gold dropped 2.1 per cent to \$4,041.59 per ounce by 1314 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery slid 2.6 per cent to \$4,043.50. Silver slid 4.3 per cent to \$57.1, platinum fell 3.1 per cent to \$1,593.17, and palladium dipped 2.8 per cent to \$1,255. REUTERS

Buy zinc futures at ₹382 with stop-loss at ₹370

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Zinc futures (₹386/kg) have been rallying steadily since June 25 after they found support at ₹350. On Wednesday, they broke out of a resistance, opening the door for further rally.

COMMODITY CALL.

The July futures, after surpassing the hurdle at ₹372 a couple of weeks ago, were trading in a sideways band of ₹372-380.

On Wednesday, they broke out of ₹380. The contract extended the rise on Thursday, and is now trading at a record level of ₹386.

The chart shows that the uptrend is intact.

The price action since June 25 shows confirmation of a bull flag chart pattern, according to which zinc futures could rally to ₹410 swiftly.

But there could be a minor

Copper will likely witness volatility on W. Asia risks

MARKET IN LIMBO. Analysts say the red metal is currently caught between macro headwinds and uncertainty over US tariffs

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Currently caught between macro headwinds and US tariff uncertainty, copper prices will likely rule volatile in the coming months due to the US-Iran conflict, analysts said.

“As we head into H2 2026, we expect copper prices to remain caught between macro headwinds and tariff uncertainty, while geopolitical risks persist, rendering the market acutely exposed to further volatility and highly sensitive to developments in the Middle East (West Asia),” said research

agency BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions.

“Tight inventories, strong import demand and falling exchange stocks suggest copper fundamentals remain supportive in the near term. Still, concerns over global growth and the Fed outlook could limit further gains,” said ING Think, the economic and financial arm of Dutch multinational financial services firm ING.

UP AT 6-WEEK HIGH

“Elevated (copper) prices are expected to persist through 2026 due to ongoing supply disruptions, tight concentrate markets and strong demand,” said Aus-

Demand-supply balance (in '000 tonnes)					
	2025	2026*	2027*	2028*	2029*
Mine output	23,654	23,682	24,417	24,999	25,594
Refined output	28,557	28,492	29,146	29,904	30,811
Consumption	27,906	28,259	28,973	29,859	30,829
Closing stocks	1,074	1,173	1,346	1,390	1,373

*Forecast #Projection Source: Office of Chief Economist, Australia

tralia's Office of Chief Economist (AOCE). Copper prices surged to a 6-week high due to a shortage outside the US and lower stocks. However, China's resistance to higher prices and inflation concerns capped the gains.

On the London Metal Exchange, copper's three-month contract is currently

quoted around \$13,800 a tonne. The red metal has gained 5 per cent in the past month and over 13 per cent year-to-date.

LME copper prices surged 38 per cent year-on-year in the first quarter, reaching a record high of \$14,500 a tonne in January, said AOCE. “Prices have since eased

but remain elevated, supported by mine disruptions and risks of sulphuric acid shortages due to the Middle East conflict. About 20 per cent of the world refined copper produced uses the acid in the solvent extraction and electrowinning (SX-EW) operations,” it said.

YANGSHAN PREMIUM

ING Think said copper prices found support at the start of the week from tightening physical market conditions in China.

“Import premiums for copper — the Yangshan premium — surged to \$100/tonne, their highest level in more than a year. This is up

from just \$20/tonne in late January as scrap shortages boosted demand for refined metal and imports,” it said.

The tightness follows Beijing's crackdown on invoice trading, which disrupted scrap flows and constrained domestic supply. Maintenance outages at several Chinese smelters also limited production.

BMI has raised its copper price forecast to \$12,700/tonne.

It reflected “sustained support to prices from converging supply-side pressures, tariff-driven tightness and AI-fuelled optimism”, which continue to propel the red metal to successive re-

cord highs, it said.

US TARIFF FEARS

AOCE said elevated prices are expected to persist through 2026 due to ongoing supply disruptions, tight concentrate markets and strong demand.

“Prices are expected to ease to about \$11,050 a tonne (real terms) by 2031, as mine supply lifts and refined output matches demand,” it said. ING Think said copper continues to find support from expectations of potential US tariffs.

BMI sees the current rally as already extending beyond what fundamentals alone would justify.

Egg prices crack a new record as heat, feed costs bite

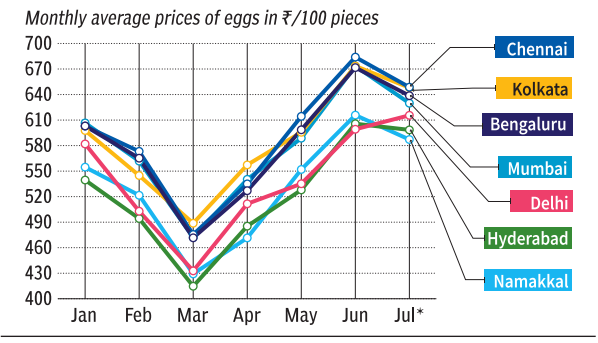
Gayathri G
Chennai

Egg prices have climbed to an all-time high in Namakkal, India's largest egg-producing hub, as a prolonged summer, lower production and soaring feed costs tighten supplies. This comes amid robust demand.

Industry stakeholders say the supply-demand mismatch could keep prices elevated in the coming weeks, while warning that shortages of key poultry feed ingredients, such as soybean meal and maize, pose a longer-term challenge.

The National Egg Coordination Committee (NECC) revised the farm-gate procurement price to a record ₹6.65 per egg on July 13, surpassing the previous high of ₹6.4 recorded on December 23 last year. Since July 16, the NECC has maintained the procurement price at ₹6.8 in Namakkal. Eggs are retailing at up to ₹8

Scaling new peaks



apiece in many markets and ₹8.50-9 in parts of Kerala.

SUMMER'S IMPACT

After last year's peak, prices eased before beginning a steady climb from June. The farm-gate price rose from ₹5.7 on June 1 to ₹6.45 on June 17, ₹6.5 on June 26, ₹6.55 on July 10, ₹6.6 on July 12 and ₹6.65 on July 13. The NECC determines wholesale procurement prices based on production levels

and market demand.

Industry representatives said the impact of the scorching summer is being felt now because birds entering the market were hatched during the peak heat period.

According to NK Saravanakumar of KL Poultry Farm, while Namakkal has the capacity to produce around nine crore eggs a day, the actual output is currently about six crore, re-

flecting the impact of weather and rising production costs.

FEED INFLATION

The production shortfall has been compounded by a sharp rise in feed costs. Saravanakumar said maize prices had increased to ₹28 per kg from ₹23 over the past three months, while soybean prices had risen to ₹71 per kg from ₹45, prompting some producers to cut output.

Vangili Subramaniam, President of the Tamil Nadu Poultry Farmers' Cooperative Society, said soaring input costs had squeezed farmer margins despite higher egg prices.

Higher temperatures have also reduced bird productivity. The tight supply situation has also pushed up broiler prices. Farm-gate chicken prices are currently around ₹150 a kg, while retail prices in several markets have climbed to ₹250 a kg, according to Subramaniam.

A bird normally attains 2.5 kg weight in 40 days. But due to the heat, birds weigh only 1.8 kg now. Layer birds' mortality, too, has increased, he said.

Ricky Thaper, Joint Secretary, Poultry Federation of India, said as the sector continues to expand, long-term availability of two critical feed ingredients — soybean meal and maize (corn) — is becoming a growing concern. Naveen Pasuparthi, Deputy Chairman, CLFMA of India and President, Karnataka Poultry Farmers and Breeders Association, said the sharp increase in soybean meal and maize prices had significantly raised production costs.

Maize prices have risen to ₹2,800-2,900 per quintal, while soybean meal has jumped to around ₹67,000 a tonne from ₹39,000-40,000 during March-April, he said.

Beyond the current price spike, the industry flagged growing concerns over feed security. Thaper said India is

currently facing a shortage of around 1.5 million tonnes of soybean meal before the arrival of the new crop later this year.

Since feed accounts for 65-70 per cent of poultry production costs, ensuring adequate supplies of maize and soybean meal is critical to keeping eggs and chicken affordable, he said.

Industry associations urged the Centre to allow limited import of genetically modified soybean meal during the lean season until the domestic crop arrives.

ROBUST DEMAND

Despite higher prices, consumption remains firm. KS Ashok Kumar of MAA Integrators, Bengaluru, said the increase in egg and chicken prices is primarily due to the seasonal decline in production during summer.

Subramaniam said chicken is far more affordable than mutton, which costs over ₹750 a kg. “Over the past decade or so, prices

of chicken have not increased as compared to mutton, which has tripled,” he said.

In Kerala, which depends heavily on Namakkal for egg supply, retail prices have risen by around ₹2 per egg over the past two months to ₹8.5-9, according to CJ George of the Stall Owners Association, Ernakulam Market.

Echoing the industry's optimism, Crisil said improved realisations from higher egg and broiler prices, coupled with steady demand, were expected to lift the Indian poultry industry's revenue growth by around 10 per cent this fiscal. However, volatility in feed costs, broiler and egg prices, as well as bird flu outbreaks are key risks.

(With inputs from Prabhudatta Mishra in New Delhi; Vishwanath Kulkarni in Bengaluru; Sajeer Kumar in Kochi; TE Raja Simhan and Subramani Ra Mancombu in Chennai)

Maize gains ground in M.P., may offset decline in Karnataka, Maharashtra

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Madhya Pradesh has reported a 23 per cent jump in maize acreage this kharif season, partly offsetting declines in key producing States such as Karnataka and Maharashtra, where delayed monsoon and rainfall deficit have hurt sowing.

Overall maize acreage is down about 5 per cent at 67.89 lakh hectares (lh) as of July 17, compared with 71.5 lh a year ago.

Per Agriculture Ministry data, maize has been sown on 23.37 lh in Madhya Pradesh till July 17, up from 19 lh in the corresponding period last year.

In contrast, Karnataka has seen acreage decline by nearly 30 per cent to 9.43 lh due to deficient rainfall, while Maharashtra's maize area is down 5.1 per cent at 9.59 lh.

Maize acreage has also declined in Rajasthan, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh, while Andhra Pradesh and Bihar have registered marginal increases.

EL NINO IMPACT

Rahul Chauhan of iGrain India said acreage had declined due to the rainfall deficit caused by the El Niño effect, though maize continues to be a preferred crop because of attractive prices.

Going by the current sowing trend and with the sowing window narrowing in Karnataka and Maharashtra, matching last year's kharif maize production appears unlikely, he added.

“The production of maize will be less as sowing has not taken place in some States due to the impact of El Niño. Also, as maize prices were lower than MSP last year, we expect a section of farmers to shift to soybean, prices of which are ruling high,” said Divya Kumar Gulati, Chairman, CLFMA of India. “It is going to be a challenge



Mixed trend

Maize acreage in lakh hectares		
	2026	2025
Madhya Pradesh	23.37	19
Maharashtra	9.59	10.1
Karnataka	9.43	13.5
Rajasthan	8.05	8.15
Uttar Pradesh	3.1	4.5
Bihar	1.92	1.7
Gujarat	1.54	1.6
Telangana	1.47	1.82
Andhra Pradesh	0.51	0.35
All India*	67.89	71.5

* Includes other states

ging year for the livestock feed sector as maize sowing has been delayed and acreage is likely to be lower. Moreover, arrivals are expected to be delayed by about a month to around December this year due to the delayed sowing,” said Naveen Pasuparthi, Deputy Chairman, CLFMA of India, and President of the Karnataka Poultry Farmers and Breeders Association.

However, sources in the ethanol sector said the kharif maize crop is unlikely to be significantly affected as the crop requires relatively less water.

They said the crop remains largely unaffected in States such as Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Telangana. Pasuparthi said that 14 poultry associations across the country had jointly funded a digital survey of key crops, such as maize and soybean, to assess crop conditions and estimate production.

South Gujarat deluge shatters records as another ‘low’ looms over Bay

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

One of the most eventful rainstorms in recent memory pummelled south Gujarat as a rare convergence of Arabian Sea moisture and favourable dynamics unleashed cloudbursts of staggering intensity, with Umergam in Valsad district recording an astonishing 106 cm of rain in just 24 hours ending Thursday morning.

The deluge rewrote rainfall charts across the region. Kapradra (Valsad) measured 79 cm, while neighbouring Silvassa in Dadra and Nagar Haveli received 74 cm. Other phenomenal totals included 66 cm at Khanvel, 63 cm at Daman FMO, 56 cm at Dharampur, 55 cm at Vapi, 54



MONSOON MENACE. Commuters waded through a waterlogged area after heavy rainfall in Surat on Thursday. PH

cm at Daman, 51 cm at Pardi, 46 cm at Nanipalson, 45 cm at Vandsa, 39 cm each at Valsad, Khergam and Dolvan, and 36 cm each at Umerpada and Waghai.

AGGRESSIVE MOOD

The India Meteorological

Department (IMD) said the monsoon will remain in an aggressive mood, forecasting fairly widespread to widespread rainfall over Central, North-West, East and North-East India over the next few days, with occasional widespread showers over South

peninsula.

The wet spell could gather fresh momentum by the end of July. Numerical weather prediction models indicate the formation of another low-pressure area over the Bay of Bengal, seeded by the remnants of a typhoon crossing the South China Sea.

The system is expected to trigger a renewed surge of rain over East India before spreading inland into the opening days of August.

Meteorologists attributed the south Gujarat cloudburst to a rare atmospheric configuration in which a temporary easing of El Niño-related suppression of clouds allowed an exceptionally moisture-laden south-westerly flow from the north-east Arabian Sea to sweep inland.

The moisture plume inter-

acted with a powerful east-west shear zone stretching from south Gujarat across Madhya Pradesh, north Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and West Bengal to Bangladesh and onward to Manipur, dramatically amplifying rainfall.

OROGRAPHIC DELUGE

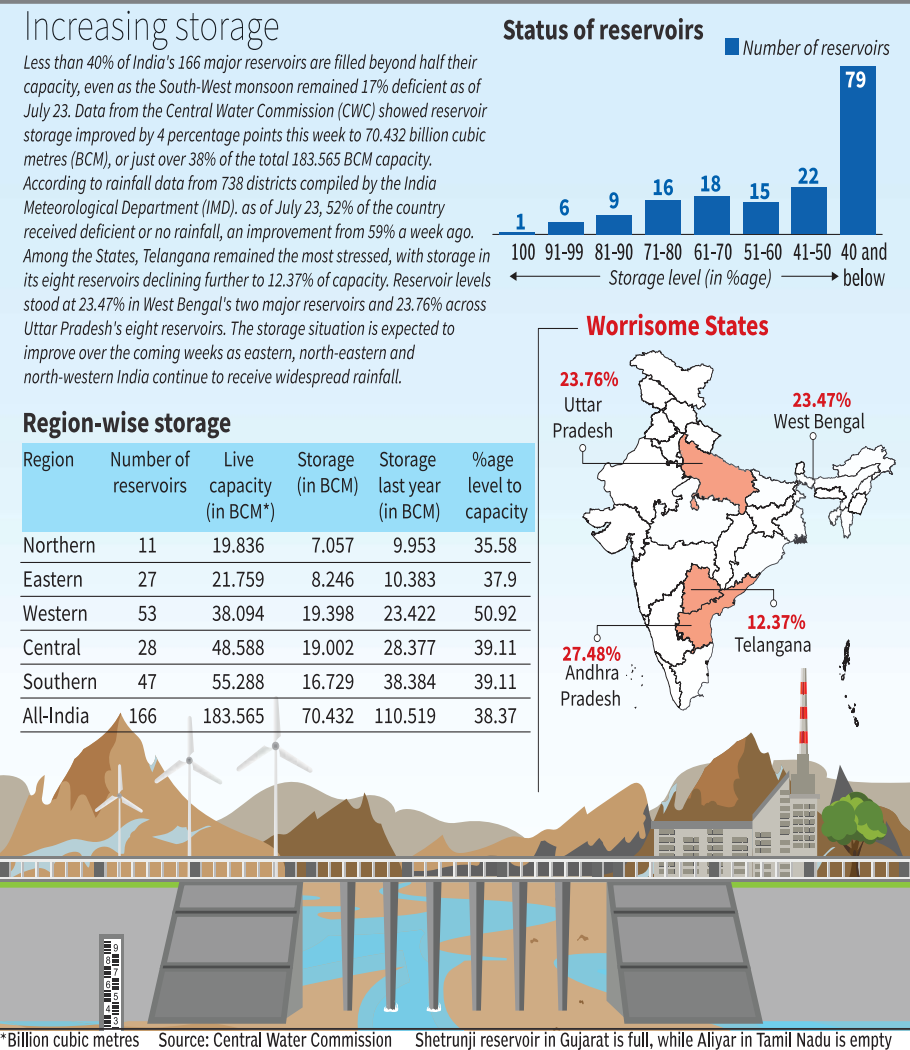
The downpour was further intensified by the rugged northern reaches of the Western Ghats around Saputara, Don Hill and Wilson Hill in the forested Dang and Valsad districts. Moist Arabian Sea winds were forced rapidly up the slopes, squeezing out torrents of rain in a classic orographic deluge rarely witnessed on such a scale.

The European Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasts (ECMWF) had

flagged the potential for exceptionally heavy rainfall over south Gujarat a day earlier. It now projects the heavy rain belt to shift northward through Friday across Vadodara, Godhra, Ahmedabad, Mehsana and adjoining areas.

The monsoon's seasonal trough, the atmospheric spine driving the rain, extended from Jaisalmir through Kota, Guna, Damoh, Daltonganj and Contai before dipping into the north-east Bay of Bengal.

The weather system was reinforced by a western disturbance over Jammu and cyclonic circulations over north-west Madhya Pradesh and south-east Rajasthan, sustaining vigorous monsoon activity across large parts of the country.



QUICKLY.

Viyona gets BBPS nod for bill payment services

Hyderabad: Viyona, a fintech infrastructure start-up, has received approval from the Bharat Bill Payment System (BBPS) to operate as a customer operating unit. The certification enables Viyona to offer BBPS-powered bill payment services across electricity, water, gas, broadband, mobile recharges, DTH subscriptions, insurance premiums, EMIs, educational fees, and other approved bill payments. **OUR BUREAU**

GMR Hyderabad Airport launches taxi service

Hyderabad: GMR Hyderabad International Airport has launched a dedicated premium airport taxi service which will be available 24/7, ensuring seamless transportation for passengers, including peak hours and holidays, according to a release. With a fleet of over 200 vehicles, the service is designed to deliver a premium, airport-assured travel experience. **OUR BUREAU**

PAC raps Defence Ministry over gaps in foreign OEMs’ offset commitments

POLICY GAP. Says 45% shortfall highlights inadequacies in the MoD’s contract management and planning

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

Parliament’s Public Accounts Committee (PAC), in a report tabled in both the Houses, has sharply criticised the Ministry of Defence (MoD) over persistent defaults, and procedural lapses in implementing the Defence Offsets Policy which mandates that foreign original equipment manufacturers (FOEMs) after winning capital procurement contracts exceeding ₹2,000 crore must invest 30 per cent of the deal value back into India’s domestic defence, aerospace, or internal security sectors. This was meant to give a fillip to the indigenous military-industrial ecosystem.

In its 50th report, titled *Management of Defence Offsets*, which is based on the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audit find-



DELIVERY PENDING. 56 offset contracts worth \$13.2 billion signed and obligations extend till 2033, says Defence Ministry

ings on the same subject, the parliamentary watchdog stated that a “strategic transition” is required in the two-decade-old policy, rather than “persisting with piecemeal modifications” that have occurred from 2006 to 2020 (further revisions are ongoing). The MoD informed the PAC, headed by Congress MP KC Venugopal, during evidence that a total of 56 offset contracts worth

\$13.21 billion have been signed since the inception of the offset policy to date. These obligations have to be met till 2033.

DEAL PLANNING Furthermore, under 26 ongoing offset contracts representing total offset commitments of \$9.91 billion, foreign vendors have submitted discharge claims worth \$5.46 billion — ap-

proximately 55 per cent of total ongoing obligations. This leaves close to 45 per cent of offset obligations unfulfilled, primarily because several offset projects planned at the time of contract signing failed to materialise in later years. The Committee noted that such failures highlight deep-seated inadequacies in the MoD’s contract management and planning.

The PAC also pulled up the Ministry for diluting the core objective of the Transfer of Technology (ToT). Under the Defence Offsets Policy 2020, foreign vendors were given wide flexibility to discharge obligations through five distinct avenues — including direct purchases/exports, FDI/joint ventures, ToT to Indian enterprises, ToT to government institutions, and technology acquisition by DRDO, it stated. The panel also observed that the

present cap of ₹2,000 crore or more is considered for defence offsets, which leaves a lot of military purchases outside the purview of the policy aimed at bringing in high-tech ToT to the domestic players. “The committee are of the considered opinion that the Ministry may explore the feasibility of making defence offsets universal for every defence capital acquisition without any threshold, although with a lower per cent of offset obligation than the current 30 per cent.”

“A comprehensive and holistic orientation of the Defence Offset Policy must be undertaken to ensure its alignment with the needs of the technological landscape and requirements of the domestic defence industry,” the report stated, adding that focus should be on attracting ToT and not on production and services.

Parliamentary panel asks FSSAI to fast-track front-of-pack Rules

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

A parliamentary panel has asked the Food Safety Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) to finalise and notify the ‘Front-of-Pack Nutrition Labelling’ regulations in a time-bound manner. It has also recommended that all food intended for or marketed to infants and children must mandatorily carry clear and prominent front-of-the-pack declarations on the presence of added sugar in grams per serving wherever applicable. It has said this should be done along with its percentage contribution to the daily energy requirement of the target age group.

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution on Thursday presented a report on *Regulation of Packaged Commodities with Specific Reference to Sugar Content in Baby Products and other Food Products* in the Parliament.



The panel has sought simple, visible and interpretive labels **MOORTHY M**

timely availability of clear and easily understandable nutritional information assumes significant importance for enabling informed dietary choices.

“The Committee further observed that the current labelling framework relies primarily on numerical disclosures, such as grams and percentages of the recommended dietary allowance, which may not be readily understood by all consumers at the point of purchase,” the report added.

It added that “clear, prominent, and interpretive front-of-pack warnings,” especially for products high in sugar, can serve as an effective consumer information tool by providing immediate and easily understandable guidance at the point of purchase.

COLOUR CODING It also recommended that the FOPNL regulations include simple, clearly visible, and interpretive labelling mechanisms. This should involve “colour-coded indicators for sugar levels in all products, using a three-colour format (red, yellow, and green) to denote high, medium, and low sugar levels, or appropriate warning labels for products high in sugar,” it added.

Centre red-flags 2.91 crore ration card beneficiaries, including 34 lakh already dead

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Centre has identified 2.91 crore suspect beneficiaries under various red-flag categories, including 6.50 lakh over the age of 100, according to a report by the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Consumer Affairs, Food, and Public Distribution.

“The Committee is happy to note that the Department has initiated data analytics for rightful targeting and has identified 2.91 crore suspect beneficiaries under various red-flag categories, including



The Department of Food and Public Distribution stated that 20.2 crore ration cards had been digitised

5.60 lakh above 100 years of age, 2.11 lakh single-member ration cards with beneficiaries below 18 years, 2.20 lakh silent ration cards, 30.06

lakh duplicate beneficiaries, and 34.12 lakh deceased beneficiaries as per Aadhaar status,” the report said.

The Committee further notes that an institutional framework has been envisaged under SMART-PDS through NIC, State Project Implementation Teams, an Empowered Committee, State Apex Committees, and third-party evaluation.

ERROR PREVENTION In this regard, the Committee recommends that the verification of red-flag beneficiaries should be completed in a time-bound mission mode with mandatory

field investigation. At the same time, utmost care must be taken to prevent the wrongful exclusion of eligible beneficiaries through robust safeguards and grievance redressal mechanisms.

In its reply to the panel, the Department of Food and Public Distribution stated that 20.2 crore ration cards have been completely digitised.

“Under these households, we have an average of around four members per ration card, resulting in 80.5 crore beneficiaries. This entire distribution is being managed through a network of 5.43 lakh ration shops. The

monthly allocation amounts to 44 lakh tonnes, and annually, it totals 608 lakh tonnes,” the government said. The National Food Security Act, 2013 (NFSA) provides for coverage of up to 75 per cent of the rural population and 50 per cent of the urban population at the all-India level for receiving food grains free at a rate of 5 kg per month for each beneficiary.

Under the NFSA, the ceiling for coverage remains at 81.35 crore beneficiaries as per the 2011 Census, so approximately 79 lakh more beneficiaries could still be added.

In a first, AP clears plan for private women’s varsity

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Andhra Pradesh Cabinet approved the establishment of Vishnu Women’s University, the first private women’s university in the State.

The Cabinet cleared a proposal to promulgate an ordinance amending the Schedule to the Andhra Pradesh Private Universities (Establishment and Regulation) Act, 2016, to include Vishnu Women’s University and Chalapathi University in the schedule and permit their sponsoring bodies to establish them under the brown-field category, Information and Public Relations Minister Kolusu Parthasarathy said.

West Asia crisis drags down Coromandel Intl Q1 PAT

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Coromandel International Ltd, a Murugappa Group company, posted a consolidated net profit of ₹382 crore in the first quarter ended June 30, 2026, compared with ₹502 crore in the comparable quarter last year, a decline of 24 per cent.

The company, however, registered a 15 per cent increase in total income at ₹8,215 crore in the quarter (₹7,126 crore).

“During the quarter, the West Asia conflict resulted in a sharp escalation in raw material prices, while subsidy rates remained inadequate to fully offset the increased input costs,” S Sankarasubramanian, MD and CEO, said in a statement.

NON-SUBSIDY BIZ “Despite this challenging environment, we could strengthen our leadership position in the phosphatic



S Sankarasubramanian, MD & CEO

fertilizers segment by improving market share and adopting a disciplined approach to production, procurement and inventory management, ensuring uninterrupted fertilizer supplies to the farming community,” he said. Also, the company leveraged the strength of its diversified business portfolio to deliver robust growth across its non-subsidy businesses.

“The 7.5 lakh tonne a year brownfield fertilizer granulation project, is progressing as planned and is expected to be completed in the fourth quarter of this financial year,” he said.

Gujarat reels under torrential rain, 1,500 rescued

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

More than 1,500 people were rescued and nearly 27,000 have been shifted to safer locations in Surat after torrential rain triggered flooding across many districts of Gujarat.

The worst-hit districts include Valsad, Navsari, Surat, Tapi and the Dangs, where the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF), the State Disaster Response Force (SDRF), police and local authorities are carrying out rescue and evacuation operations since Wednesday. Umargam in Valsad district received nearly 43 inches of rain over the past 28 hours. arge areas of Ahmedabad were inundated, prompting the authorities to close schools until Friday.

BUSINESS IMPACT The affected districts are part of one of Gujarat’s key industrial corridors, which is home to textile, diamond,



MONSOON MISERY. Residential buildings were partially submerged on Thursday after incessant rain in Navsari, Gujarat **PM**

chemical, pharmaceutical, and engineering units. However, the State government or industrial associations have not yet reported any major disruptions till now.

Around 200 people stranded across 11 villages in Navsari due to flooding in Kaveri river were rescued.

Officials said one drowning death was reported in Tapi district.

Apart from Navsari, another 1,200 were rescued in Surat, 50 in Ahmedabad, and 50 in Valsad. The authorities also evacuated 12,000 persons from low-lying areas in Valsad, Navsari (10,000 per-

sons), and Surat (4,900), among others.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel on Thursday chaired a review meeting at the State Emergency Operation Centre in Gandhinagar to assess the situation and directed the deployment of additional NDRF and SDRF

teams in Surat, Valsad and Navsari. He instructed officials to accord top priority to rescuing people stranded in floodwaters and evacuating residents from low-lying areas.

Patel held telephonic discussions with the Collectors of the affected districts to review operations, flood levels in rivers, and availability of services, including electricity, drinking water and transport. He directed officials to ensure sanitation, food packets, and medical support for those in shelters.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah spoke to Patel and assured the State of the Centre’s full support for rescue, relief and rehabilitation efforts.

Relief Commissioner Gaurav Makwana said south Gujarat, particularly the districts of Valsad, Navsari, Surat and Tapi, were under a red alert for extremely heavy rain since Wednesday. Apart from Umargam, Kaprada, Vapi and parts of Valsad also

witnessed exceptionally heavy rainfall overnight.

He said NDRF and SDRF teams had been pre-positioned in vulnerable areas before the rainfall intensified, and additional teams were mobilised overnight as the situation worsened. Rescue operations have been carried out jointly by the disaster response forces, police and local volunteers.

RELIEF OPERATIONS Surat currently has three NDRF and five SDRF teams, while Valsad has two NDRF and four SDRF teams, with additional teams being rushed. Navsari has two SDRF teams, while one NDRF team is being moved from Surat.

Two more NDRF teams from New Delhi are expected to reach Valsad on Thursday. The Army has deployed a 70-member team equipped with boats, while the IAF and the Coast Guard have been kept on standby for air rescue operations once weather conditions improve.

KTR serves legal notice to Telangana CM for linking him with Globe Arena

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Bharat Rashtra Samithi (BRS) Working President KT Rama Rao (KTR) served a legal notice on Chief Minister Revanth Reddy, demanding an unconditional public apology within 48 hours for linking his name to Globe Arena and calling it his ‘benami’ company.

Globe Arena, rechristened as Coempt, was recently embroiled in a controversy around the Central Board for Secondary Education’s answer sheet evaluation after a student hacker flagged glitches in the solution. The company, however, denied the allegations, saying that the hacked server was a test-

ing server and not the main one.

Reddy made the allegations at a dharna organised at Kodangal on Wednesday to protest against the Centre’s high-handed approach to the protests by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) and the “attack” on Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi.

KTR, a former IT and Industries Minister under the previous BRS government, said, “If Globe Arena is truly my benami company, why did the Congress government itself enter into agreements with that company? Your own government signed contracts with the firm, and today you are claiming that it is my benami company.”

ePlane Company, Apollo Hospitals ink MoU for air ambulances and medical drones

Rohan Das
Chennai

IIT Madras-incubated electric aircraft start-up The ePlane Company has signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with healthcare major Apollo Hospitals to introduce air ambulances.

Under the partnership, the private hospital chain has expressed intent to procure The ePlane Company’s e200x air ambulances that will facilitate rapid inter-hospital transfers, trauma response, cardiac and stroke emergencies and organ transport, as well as its subsidiary Amber Wings’ unmanned aerial vehicles that quickly move blood products, vaccines, medicines and samples.

Speaking to *businessline* Divya Manchanda, EVP Business Partnerships and AAM Strategy, The ePlane Company, said Apollo’s large healthcare network enables faster go-to-market for the company’s air ambulances without having to build healthcare infrastructure from scratch.

“Apollo is giving us an extensive network to deploy air ambulances as their hospitals and pharmacies serve nearly 18,000 pin codes,” she said.

Manchanda added that the MoU also outlines the possibility for future strategic investments in the company by Apollo Hospitals without revealing further details regarding the nature or scope of the investment. eVTOL-based ambulance services will be

seven times cheaper than using road transport while at a fraction of the cost of traditional helicopters, the company said in a media release.

Meanwhile, the company recently unveiled its first full-scale prototype of its eVTOL aircraft e200X PT-01.

Manchanda said that this prototype will be for ground testing while the company is simultaneously working on the second prototype, which will be suitable for flight testing. It intends to complete these tests and receive full certification from the regulators by early 2027.

While The ePlane Company currently operates out of its facility within IIT Madras’ Discovery Campus, it is also evaluating options for a dedicated manufactur-

ing unit with a planned capacity of 80 aircraft in the first year.

ORDERS IN PLACE The company had earlier this year secured a \$1-billion order from ICATT to deliver 788 air ambulances across India.

As for the pilots required to fly these planes, “The exact flight duty time limitations and other specifics are yet to be specified by the regulator. We are awaiting final regulations,” she added.

This collaboration with The ePlane Company reflects our commitment to bringing Apollo’s clinical excellence to every corner of the country, however remote,” Dr Prathap C Reddy, Chairman, Apollo Hospitals Group, said in a statement.

JSW’s ₹600-crore project at VOC Port to be ready by Q4

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The ₹600-crore dry bulk cargo terminal mechanisation project being implemented by JSW Infrastructure at the VO Chidambaranar (VOC) Port in Thoothukudi is expected to be completed by the fourth quarter of the current fiscal, boosting the port’s capability to handle larger dry bulk cargo volumes.

According to the company’s latest investor presentation, the project involves mechanisation of the North Cargo Berth-III (NCB-III) with a handling capacity of 7 million tonnes per annum (mtpa).

Civil works relating to the conveyor system have been completed, while building-related civil works are in pro-

gress. JSW Infrastructure signed the design, build, finance, operate and transfer (DBFOT), 30-year concession agreement with the VOC Port Authority in July 2024.

The terminal is designed to handle a range of dry bulk cargo, including coal, coke, limestone, gypsum, rock phosphate and copper concentrate.

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